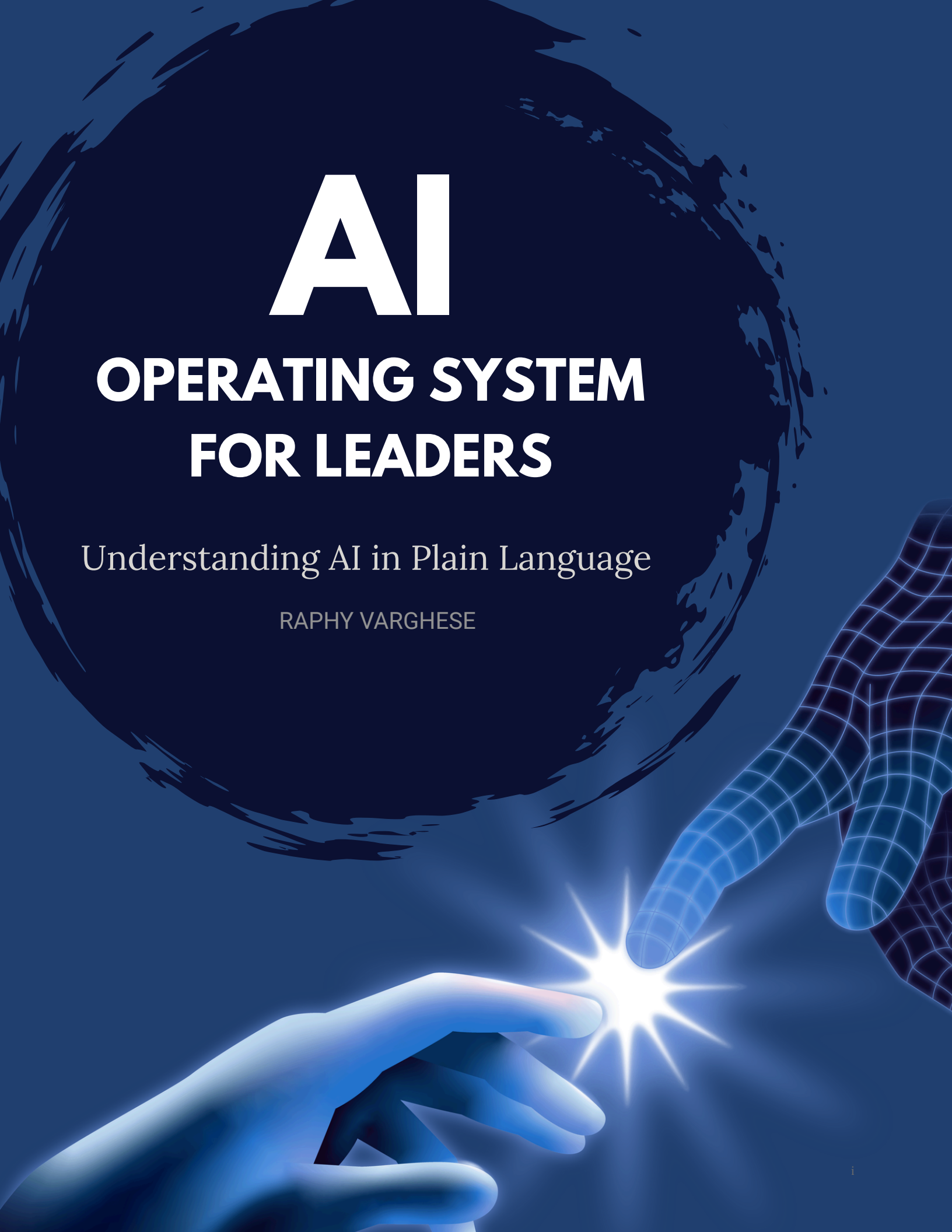


AI

OPERATING SYSTEM FOR LEADERS

Understanding AI in Plain Language

RAPHY VARGHESE



AI Operating System for Leaders

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Disclaimer

The business and strategy frameworks presented in this book are established methodologies created by their original thinkers, researchers, and organisations all of whom are credited throughout the text. The author makes no claim of ownership over these frameworks.

This book is a curated collection: the author's original contribution lies in the selection, synthesis, sequencing, and the AI prompt architecture built around each framework. The prompts, the curation logic, and the structured learning system are the author's original work.

Results from applying any framework will vary based on individual circumstances, context, and execution. This book is intended as a practical reference guide and does not constitute professional legal, financial, or business advice.

A Note from the Author

The frameworks in this book were not invented by me. They were built by some of the sharpest minds in business, strategy, psychology, and leadership over the past century. I collected them because I believe access to the right thinking tools should not depend on where you went to school, who you know, or how much you can afford to spend on advisors.

My work was to find the frameworks that matter most, pair each one with a prompt that makes AI genuinely useful, and put the whole system in your hands. If even one framework changes the way you think through a problem, this book has done its job.

— Raphy Varghese

Printed in India

For the ones who made me possible.

To my family —
for the safety net that let me take every leap.

To my wife —
for the patience, the partnership, and the quiet strength that holds everything together.

To my friends —
who challenged my thinking, celebrated the wins, and stayed through the harder seasons.

To my mentors —
for seeing what I could not yet see in myself, and pointing me toward it anyway.

To God Almighty —
for the purpose woven into every problem I was given to solve.

And to every future enthusiast who believes the best is not behind us, this book is proof that it is not.

About the Author

I am not a professor. I am not a consultant writing from the sidelines.

I have sat in the same room as every problem in this book no playbook, no team, no clear path forward and I have had to think my way through every one of them. What I learned is that the right framework, asked the right way to AI, turns hours of confusion into minutes of clarity.

I wrote this book for the founder building their first company without a mentor in the room. The manager who became a leader before they felt ready. The student who wants to think at a level most peers have not reached yet. The professional who knows they are capable of more but does not yet have the language or the structure to unlock it.

I have spent years at the intersection of people, strategy, and technology - building teams, advising founders, mentoring emerging leaders, and watching what separates the ones who break through from the ones who stay stuck. It is almost never talent. It is almost always tools and the thinking habits that go with them.

This is not theory. Every framework here is one I have used when it actually mattered. Every prompt was written to produce something useful, not something that sounds impressive.

I believe the best leaders do not hoard the map. They hand it out.

That is why this book exists.

— **Raphy Varghese**

Builder · Strategist · AI Practitioner · Human-Centered Leadership Futurist

This Book Is a Ticket to Your Future

— *and it starts working the moment you open it*

EVERY LEADER HAS THE SAME THREE CONSTRAINTS

You have time. You have energy. You have money. That is everything you have to work with. Waste any of them and your goals take longer. Protect all three and your future arrives earlier than it was supposed to.

Most people waste all three every day not because they are careless, but because they are working without the right tools. They spend three hours on a decision a clear framework resolves in twenty minutes. They burn energy feeling stuck on a problem that has been solved before just not by them. They spend money on advice, on mistakes, on reinventing things that did not need reinventing.

This book exists to change that. It is built around one insight:

THE CORE INSIGHT

When you give a well-designed framework to an AI model, you are not just asking a question. You are giving it a structure that directs years of pattern recognition at your specific problem. The output you receive in four minutes would previously have taken a week of research, reflection, or paid expertise.

108 frameworks. 108 prompts. Each one a shortcut through a problem that used to cost you time, energy, or money.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

Before AI, expertise was expensive and slow. A well-trained AI model has processed more business literature, case studies and real-world patterns than any individual could read in a lifetime.

The problem is not the AI's knowledge. The problem is the question. A vague prompt gets a vague answer. A structured prompt one built around a proven framework gets a decade of relevant experience applied directly to your situation.

THE THREE RESOURCES THIS BOOK PROTECTS

TIME

Save 20–30 hours every week

Frameworks cut decision time from hours to minutes. Leaders using structured prompts spend less time searching, drafting and second-guessing and more time building, deciding and leading.

ENERGY

End the frustration of being stuck

Every framework in this book is a path through a problem that previously had no clear exit. Less stuckness means more capacity for the things and the people that actually matter.

MONEY

Reduce the cost of wrong decisions

Wrong decisions made without the right frame are expensive. Consultants, wasted hires, failed launches, missed positioning—these have a price. The right framework at the right moment pays for itself many times over.

IF YOU PROTECT ALL THREE

The leader who uses the right frame on the right problem at the right moment does not just solve faster, they compound. Every good decision creates space for the next one. Every hour saved is an hour invested in building. Your future arrives early.

THE MISSION BEHIND THIS BOOK

What separates leaders who succeed fastest from everyone else is rarely intelligence. It is access to the right thinking tools at the right moment.

My mission: put these tools in the hands of every leader—not just the ones in business schools with expensive advisors and curated networks. The first-generation entrepreneur. The student who does not yet know they will lead something important. The manager who stepped up before they felt ready.

The most dangerous gap in modern leadership is not a gap in ambition. It is a gap in tools. This book closes that gap.

WHO THIS BOOK IS FOR

This book was written for leaders but not just the ones who already have the title.

The Founder	Building the first company without a mentor in the room.
The Manager	Who became a leader before they felt ready.
The Student	Who wants to think at a level most peers have not reached yet.
The Professional	Who knows they are capable of more but lacks the structure to unlock it.
The First-Generation Builder	No expensive network, no curated MBA. Just drive and the right tools.

WHY FRAMEWORKS MAKE AI SO MUCH MORE POWERFUL

An AI language model does not think the way a human thinks. What it does extraordinarily well is pattern-match against an enormous amount of text. A vague question returns a statistically likely answer. A structured question within a clear framework returns patterns specifically relevant to that framework’s domain and objectives.

WITHOUT A FRAMEWORK “Help me with my pricing strategy.” Generic advice that applies to no one.	WITH VALUE LADDER (2.7) “Act as a pricing consultant. Design a 4-tier Value Ladder for [MY BUSINESS], with price points, offer names, and the customer upgrade logic between each tier.” A specific, actionable pricing architecture for your exact business.
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This is not a book about AI. It is a book about thinking better, faster with AI as your thinking partner.

— Raphy Varghese

Understanding AI in Plain Language

WHAT IS AN AI LANGUAGE MODEL?

An AI language model like ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini has read an enormous amount of text: books, articles, research, websites. From all of that, it learned patterns. It learned how experts in every field think and write. It learned what a good answer looks like across hundreds of different contexts.

THE SIMPLEST WAY TO THINK ABOUT IT

“Think of it like a person who has read everything, in every field but has never met you. The more you tell it, the more useful it becomes.”

HOW AI HAS CHANGED — AND WHY IT MATTERS NOW

Until 2022, AI tools were narrow. A model trained to translate could not write. A model trained to play chess could not advise on strategy. Each AI did one thing.

That changed with large language models. For the first time, a single AI could hold a conversation, write code, analyse data, draft a strategy, review a contract, and simulate a customer often within the same session. The shift was not incremental. It was a step-change.

What this means for you: the gap between someone who uses AI well and someone who does not is no longer a technology gap. It is a thinking gap. The person who knows how to frame a problem clearly using a proven framework gets outputs that feel like expert advice. Everyone else gets noise.

THE 3 THINGS THAT DETERMINE YOUR OUTPUT

Master these three inputs and every prompt in this book performs at its highest level.

1. What you ask (the prompt)	A vague question gets a vague answer. A structured prompt built around a clear framework gets a specific, useful answer. Every framework in this book has a ready-made prompt you never start blank.
2. The role you give it	"Help me with pricing" is generic. "Act as a pricing consultant advising a SaaS startup" is specific. Every prompt in this book begins with a role assignment that focuses the output immediately.
3. The context you provide	AI does not know your business unless you tell it. The bracket fields [YOUR PRODUCT], [YOUR CUSTOMER], [YOUR GOAL] are not optional. They transform a universal framework into advice for your specific situation.

WEAK PROMPT VS STRONG PROMPT

WEAK	STRONG
<i>"Help me with my sales process."</i>	<i>"Act as a B2B sales coach. My product: [X]. Apply the LAER framework to my top 3 objections."</i>
Generic tips, no context, applies to no one.	Word-for-word objection responses for your actual product.

KEY INSIGHT

Aframework tells AI where to look. Your context tells it who it is looking for. Both are essential. The prompts in this book handle the framework you supply the context.

WHAT AI DOES EXCEPTIONALLY WELL

Structured analysis	Give it a framework and a problem, expert-level output in minutes.
First-draft generation	Proposals, emails, SOPs, strategies faster than any writer.
Role simulation	Act as a customer, critic, lawyer, or mentor. Stress-test safely.
Pattern recognition	It has seen more business situations than any advisor you could hire.
Iteration	Responds to feedback. Gets better the more specific you are.
Prompt chaining	Each output can become the input for the next framework. Results compound.

WHAT AI CANNOT DO — AND WHERE YOU COME IN

AI does not know your customers. It cannot feel the politics of your team, read the specific human in front of you, or carry the weight of a decision the way you can. AI gives you the map. You still have to walk the terrain.

Real relationships	Cannot build trust, read a room, or carry the weight of human accountability.
Lived experience	No memory of your failures or wins. Context must always come from you.
Ethical judgment	Can surface options. Deciding what is right for your people and values is yours.
Creative courage	Can remix patterns. The originality to build what no one has built is human.
Verification	Always verify specific numbers, names and statistics. AI can hallucinate with confidence.

THE RIGHT RELATIONSHIP WITH AI

The leaders who get the most from AI are not the ones who trust it blindly or the ones who distrust it entirely. They are the ones who know exactly which problems to give it, and which ones to own themselves.

YOUR FIRST 10 MINUTES WITH ANY AI TOOL

If you are new to AI, do this once. It rewires how you interact with it.

- 1. Open any AI tool:** ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini. All three are free to start. Pick one.
- 2. Set the role:** Type: “You are a business strategy advisor working with a founder building [YOUR BUSINESS TYPE].”
- 3. Run your first framework prompt:** Choose any framework from Module 1. Copy the prompt, fill in your context in the bracket fields, and paste it in.
- 4. Iterate once:** After the first response, reply: “Keep everything but make [section] more specific to [your context].” Notice the difference.
- 5. Save what works:** Copy your best prompts into a notes app. You are building a personal AI toolkit that knows your business better with every session.

THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS MOST

If the first answer is not right, do not start over. Respond to it. Tell the AI what was good and what to change. AI conversations compound. The best output often comes in the second message, not the first.

Think of it like briefing a very well-read colleague who is new to your business. Their first response is their best guess. Your follow-up gives them the context to do better. Most people never send that follow-up. That is where the value lives.

That is everything you need to know. Turn the page and start.

Seven Terms Every AI User Should Know

Read through once. Nothing in this book will feel unfamiliar.

Prompt

The message you type to the AI. Every framework in this book provides one you never start from a blank page.

Hallucination

When AI confidently states something untrue. Frameworks reduce this by constraining where AI looks. Always verify specific numbers or names.

Context Window

The text AI can hold in one conversation like a whiteboard. For normal use in this book, you will never hit this limit.

Zero-Shot

Asking AI to do something with no examples, just clear instructions. Most prompts in this book are zero-shot and work immediately.

Few-Shot

Adding one or two examples before your request. If a prompt gives slightly wrong results, add one good example first it transforms quality.

Temperature

How creative vs precise AI is. If outputs feel too random: “Be more precise.” If too rigid: “Be more creative.”

Prompt Chaining

Using one prompt’s output as the next prompt’s input. The “Pairs Well With” line on each framework page shows exactly how to do this.

 *"Terms current as of 2026. AI evolves fast; if a definition here feels outdated, that's a good sign of how much progress happened."*

How to Use This Book

Open it to the challenge. Find the framework. Use the prompt today.

This book is not meant to be read cover to cover. It is a tool. Open it when you have a real problem in front of you. Use the Situation Index to find the right framework, then use the prompt immediately.

WHAT YOU WILL FIND ON EVERY PAGE

USE THIS WHEN	The trigger situation, know in 5 seconds if this page is for you.
THE FRAMEWORK	The mental model, its origin, and what it was built to solve.
HOW TO USE IT	Step-by-step: what to fill in, what to expect from the output.
AI PROMPT	Copy-ready. Paste into ChatGPT, Claude, or any LLM. Variables are [LIKE THIS].
PRO TIP	One insight from practice that multiplies the output.
DIFFICULTY TAG	BEGINNER · INTERMEDIATE · ADVANCED - find your right entry point.
PAIRS WELL WITH	Related frameworks to combine for consulting-level results.
ORIGIN	Where the framework came from, so you can go deeper if you want to.

DIFFICULTY LEVELS

BEGINNER	No prior knowledge needed. Use on day one.
INTERMEDIATE	More value after 3+ months running your business.
ADVANCED	Best with real data, a real team, and real stakes.

FRAMEWORK STACKING — THE SECRET WEAPON

The most powerful use of this book is combining two or three frameworks in one prompt session. See the Framework Stacking section (p. xvii) for five ready-to-run stacks.

The leaders who get the most from this book are not the ones who read it most carefully. They are the ones who use it most often.

Where Do I Start?

Three questions. Thirty seconds. Straight to the right page.

WHAT IS YOUR BIGGEST CHALLENGE RIGHT NOW?

I need to think more clearly or solve a specific problem	Module 1
I need to build or redesign my business model	Module 2
I need to understand my market or competition	Module 3
I need to sell better or build a sales process	Module 4
I need to market my product or build an audience	Module 5
I need to build, manage or lead my team	Module 6
I need to systemise and scale my operations	Module 7
I need to make a big decision with more confidence	Module 8
I need to understand my numbers or financial position	Module 9
I need to lead myself better habits, energy, purpose	Module 10

HOW MUCH TIME DO YOU HAVE?

5 min	Situation Index > straight to that framework page.
30 min	Read one module intro + run one framework prompt in a live AI session.
2 hours	Work through an entire module from intro to all frameworks.
Ongoing	Keep the book at your desk. Open it before every major decision.

ARE YOU NEW TO AI?

New to AI	Read "Understanding AI" (p. viii–xi), then start with 1.0 The AI Mental Model.
Occasional user	Jump to your module. The prompts are copy-ready. You will get results immediately.
Regular AI user	Go straight to the Situation Index. Your value here is the framework layer.

 Pick the one challenge that matters most right now. Find your framework. Run the prompt today. That single action will do more than finishing this introduction.

Framework Stacking

Two or three frameworks combined produce consulting-level output.

Each framework in this book is powerful alone. But the real leverage comes when you chain them using one framework's output as the context input for the next. The “Pairs Well With” line on every page is your guide.

Build a go-to-market from scratch

3.4 ICP > 5.1 StoryBrand > 5.6 Go-To-MarketCanvas > 4.1 Cold Outreach

Four sessions. A complete GTM strategy.

Competitive strategy deep-dive

3.1 SWOT > 3.3 Porter's Five Forces > 2.4 Blue Ocean Strategy

Three sessions. Consulting-level competitive positioning.

Hire and onboard your first team member

6.4 Hiring with AI > 6.1 RACI Matrix > 6.3 1-on-1 Framework

Three sessions. A complete hiring and onboarding flow.

Launch a product or offer

2.6 MVP Design > 5.6 Go-To-Market > 5.7 Launch Playbook > 8.2 Pre-Mortem

Four sessions. Launch with confidence, not hope.

Make a high-stakes decision

8.2 Pre-Mortem > 8.4 RiskMatrix > 8.6 Red Team > 8.1 DECIDE Framework

Four sessions. A decision you can defend to anyone.

HOW TO BUILD YOUR OWN STACK

The “PairsWell With” line on every framework page is curated not random. Those pairings were chosen because the frameworks' outputs feed each other. Follow them and you will build compound thinking that no single prompt can match.

Reading Paths

Four archetypes. Are commended module order for each.

Find your archetype below for a guided path through the modules.

The Pre-Revenue Founder

You have an idea, early customers, or a side project becoming a business.

MODULE ORDER: 2 > 3 > 4 > 1 > 5

Module 2 to validate the model. Module 3 to confirm your ICP. Module 4 next revenue before everything.

Module 1 builds your AI thinking in parallel. Module 5 once you have something that converts.

Skip first: Modules 6 and 7 can wait until you have a team.

The Manager Becoming a Leader

You lead a team and want to lead it better.

MODULE ORDER: 6 > 8 > 7 > 10 > 1

Module 6 is your core. Module 8 immediately after good leaders make good decisions under pressure.

Module 7 to build systems that don't depend on you. Module 10 because leadership starts inside.

Skip first: Modules 2, 3, 5 are less urgent unless you also run P&L;

The Marketer or Growth Professional

You are responsible for growth, brand, content, or go-to-market.

MODULE ORDER: 5 > 3 > 4 > 2 > 9

Module 5 is your home base. Module 3 for competitive intelligence. Module 4 marketers who understand sales close the loop. Module 2 for business model clarity. Module 9 to speak the language of metrics that matter.

Skip first: Modules 6 and 7 are secondary unless you manage a team.

The Student or Emerging Leader

You are building your thinking toolkit before you have a title.

MODULE ORDER: 1 > 10 > 8 > 2 > 3

Module 1 is where every leader should start. Module 10 build the habits now, before the pressure arrives.

Module 8 the most transferable skill in business. Modules 2 and 3 give you the fluency most graduates lack entirely.

Skip first: None. You have the most to gain from every module.

The AI Framework Ecosystem

The book is where you learn the frameworks. The digital tools are where you run them faster.

Every framework in this book comes with a copy-ready AI prompt. As AI tools continue to evolve, so does the way you can access them. What started as a companion app is growing into a broader digital ecosystem built around one goal: the right framework in your hands at the right moment, with as little friction as possible.

WHAT THE DIGITAL TOOLS DO

Situation matching	Describe your challenge. The tool identifies the right framework.
Prompt generation	Builds a complete, framework-structured prompt perfectly formatted.
One-tap copy	Paste directly into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or any AI tool you use.
Framework stacks	Pre-built multi-framework sequences for complex challenges.
Evolving library	New frameworks, prompts and workflows added as the ecosystem grows.

FIND THE CURRENT TOOLS

The ecosystem is expanding. The most current version of every digital tool apps, web tools, integrations, or AI-native experiences built since this book went to print lives at:

[QR CODE]

THE BOOK + THE TOOLS

Thebook does not expire. The frameworks in these pages are proven over decades. The digital tools will keep evolving around them. Together, they form a system that gets more useful the more the world changes.

Situation Index

Find your situation. Jump straight to that page.

Do not search for a framework by name. Search for your situation. Find the line that matches where you are right now, and go directly to the framework numbers shown.

THINKING & MENTAL CLARITY

I am new to AI and don't know how it actually works	1.0
I don't know how to get good outputs from AI	1.1, 1.2, 1.3
My AI responses feel generic and off-target	1.2, 1.3
I want AI to think like a specific expert	1.3
I get one AI output and don't know how to improve it	1.4
I need to evaluate an idea from every angle at once	1.5
I want creative angles for an old problem..	1.11 SCAMPER
I'm stuck in how things have always been done	1.6, 1.12
A decision seems good but I'm worried about side effects	1.7
I want to stress-test an idea by asking what makes it fail	1.8
I'm in a fast-moving situation and need to act now.... ..	1.10

BUSINESS DESIGN & STRATEGY

I'm not sure if my product solves a real problem	2.1, 2.5, 3.8
I need to map my entire business on one page	2.2, 2.3
I'm pre-revenue and need to validate fast	2.3, 2.6
I need to map my entire business on one page	2.9 Ansoff
I want to understand what truly delights my customers	2.10 Kano
I'm competing in a very crowded market	2.4, 3.3, 3.6
I don't understand the real reason customers buy	2.5
Someone asks why a competitor can't just copy you	2.8, 3.3

MARKET & COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

I need a structured snapshot of where I stand	3.1 SWOT
I'm entering a new market or geography	3.2, 3.3, 3.5
I want to understand my industry's power dynamics	3.3 Porter's
I'm talking to everyone and converting no one	3.4, 3.9 STP
An investor asks how big my market is	3.5 TAM SAM SOM
People don't understand what makes me different	3.7, 3.10, 2.4
I'm making decisions based on assumptions not data	3.8

SALES

My cold outreach gets ignored	4.1, 4.6
I'm pitching too early and talking too much on calls	4.2 SPIN
I'm spending time on prospects who never buy	4.3 BANT
Prospects don't see the need to change	4.4 Challenger
Prospects keep saying it's too expensive	4.5, 2.7
My messages explain features but create no emotion	4.6, 4.11 FAB
I write proposals clients read but don't sign	4.7
I send one follow-up then give up	4.8
My pipeline looks full but nothing is closing	4.9, 4.10

MARKETING & BRAND

My website or pitch deck is confusing	5.1 StoryBrand
My content gets zero engagement	5.2, 5.5
I need a complete marketing strategy	5.3, 5.4, 5.6
I don't sound like myself in my content	5.7 Brand Voice
I want to build viral growth into my product	5.8, 5.9, 5.10

TEAM & LEADERSHIP

Nobody knows who is responsible for what	6.1 RACI
My team works hard but not on the right things	6.2 OKRs, 7.4
Strategy isn't connecting to daily team action	6.10 Hoshin Kanri
I avoid giving tough feedback	6.5 SBI, 6.9
I'm doing everything myself — I can't let go	6.7 Delegation
I hired well but the culture is drifting	6.6 Culture Code

OPERATIONS & SYSTEMS

Processes depend on memory not documentation	7.1, 7.2, 7.10
We fix the same problems repeatedly	7.12, 7.3
I am building something but unclear what the customer needs	7.7, 2.1, 2.5
I want to build a culture of continuous improvement I	Kaizen 7.4,
can't prioritise — everything feels equally urgent	7.5, 8.7

DECISIONS

I'm facing a big decision and going in circles	8.1, 8.9 8.2,
I'm about to launch — what could go wrong?	8.4, 8.6
I need to quantify which risk is worth taking	8.10
I keep second-guessing a decision I already made	8.3 Post-Mortem
I'm making a big life or career decision	8.8 Regret Min.

FINANCE & METRICS

Investors ask about numbers I can't answer	9.1, 9.3, 9.5
I'm not sure how long my runway will last	9.2, 9.8
I have 20 KPIs and none feel like the right one	9.3, 9.4
I need to tell a financial story to investors	9.5, 9.6
I'm growing but not sure if it's sustainable	9.9 Rule of 40

PERSONAL LEADERSHIP & EFFECTIVENESS

I'm always busy but not making real progress	10.3, 8.7
I don't know what work gives me real energy	10.9 Ikigai
I'm paralysed by perfectionism before launching	10.11 Wabi-Sabi
I want to build reflection into my weekly routine	10.10, 10.7
I want to build habits that actually stick	10.6 Atomic Habits
I need to plan the next 90 days clearly I	10.2, 10.5
want to build my personal brand	10.8

Use the Situation Index before every major challenge. You will rarely need more than 30 seconds to find the right page.

MODULE 1

Think Like a Strategist

Learn to work with AI. Then learn to think. Both are non-negotiable.

WHAT THIS MODULE DOES

Most founders fail with AI not because they lack access but because they never built the foundation. This module gives you two things: the skills to work with AI effectively, and the thinking frameworks that make every decision sharper with or without AI.

SECTION A — HOW TO WORK WITH AI

- 1.0 The AI Mental Model
- 1.1 C.A.R.E Prompting
- 1.2 The Context Stack
- 1.3 Role Prompting — The Expert Chair
- 1.4 The Refinement Loop

SECTION B — HOW TO THINK

- 1.5 Six Thinking Hats
- 1.6 First Principles Thinking
- 1.7 Second Order Thinking
- 1.8 Inversion Thinking
- 1.9 Mental Models Library
- 1.10 OODA Loop
- 1.11 SCAMPER
- 1.12 MECE Framework

Start here always. Return here when outputs feel shallow or decisions feel foggy.

1.0 — The AI Mental Model

Understand what you are working with before you work with it

USE THIS WHEN

You are new to AI, your outputs feel unpredictable, or you need to explain how AI works to your team in a way that actually helps them use it.

THE FRAMEWORK

An LLM is a prediction engine, not a thinking machine. It has read an enormous amount of human text and learned to predict what a useful response looks like given what you gave it. It has no memory between sessions. It cannot verify facts. It has no agenda. It is extraordinarily good at one thing: producing structured, relevant output when given clear structure and rich context.

Three things determine every output you get:

Role: who the AI is reasoning as. Vague role = generic output. Context what the AI knows about your situation. Missing context = missing relevance. Expectation what a good answer looks like. No expectation = AI guesses.

As AI evolves from prompting to context engineering to agentic systems these three requirements stay constant. The technology changes. The need for clear human intent does not.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Before every AI session, ask: have I given it a Role, Context, and Expectation?
2. When output feels wrong, diagnose which of the three is missing do not rewrite randomly.
3. When introducing AI to your team, use this page as the one-minute briefing.
4. Return here whenever AI feels unpredictable. The answer is almost always in these three.

I want to understand how to work with you more effectively.

My situation: [WHO I AM - role, industry, company stage]

What I typically use AI for: [YOUR MAIN USE CASES]

Based on this, tell me:

1. Where am I most likely leaving quality on the table?
2. What context should I always give you that I probably forget?
3. What is one thing I can do differently from today that would improve every output I get from you?

Be direct. Assume I am smart but new to working with AI well.

How to improve AI output?

Define Role

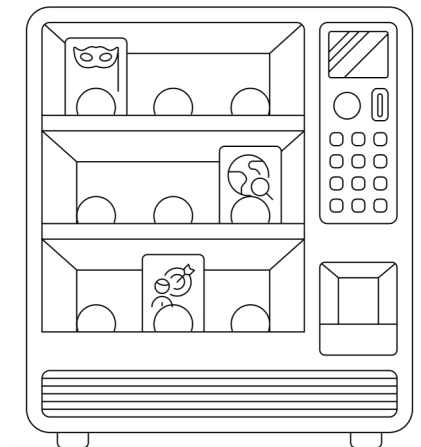
Specifies the AI's perspective, leading to more tailored responses.

Provide Context

Informs the AI about the situation, ensuring relevance.

Set Expectations

Guides the AI towards the desired output format and content.



PRO TIP

The most common mistake is treating a bad output as a model failure. It is almost never the model. It is almost always a missing Role, thin Context, or no stated Expectation. Diagnose before you retry.

Pairs well with: 1.1 C.A.R.E Prompting · 1.2 Context Stack · 1.3 Role Prompting · 1.4 Refinement ...

1.1 — C.A.R.E Prompting

How LLMs actually think and how to work with that

USE THIS WHEN

You're new to AI and getting inconsistent, generic outputs. You want a reliable structure that makes every prompt work better from day one.

THE FRAMEWORK

LLMs respond to structure. C.A.R.E gives every prompt four layers: **Context** (the situation), **Action** (what you want done), **Role** (who the AI should be), **Expectation** (what the output should look like). Every strong prompt has all four. Most weak prompts are missing two.

Context is usually the layer people skip, and it does the heaviest lifting since the AI has no idea who you are or what you need without it. Role is the fastest lever for quality, narrowing vocabulary and depth instantly. Expectation is where most prompts fail silently: if you don't state a length or format, the AI guesses one for you.

Origin: Prompt Engineering community best practice — popularised 2022–2023

HOW TO USE IT

1. Identify what you need: a decision, a draft, an analysis, or a plan.
2. Fill in each C.A.R.E layer before prompting even just mentally.
3. Start every prompt with the Role. It sets the entire tone.
4. State Expectation clearly: format, length, tone, and depth.

IN PRACTICE

A B2B SaaS founder was getting generic copy from AI. After adding Role ('Act as a direct-response copywriter who specialises in B2B SaaS') and Expectation ('3 subject lines, under 8 words, curiosity-gap style'), his open rate jumped from 18% to 31% in one send. Same brief. One C.A.R.E pass.

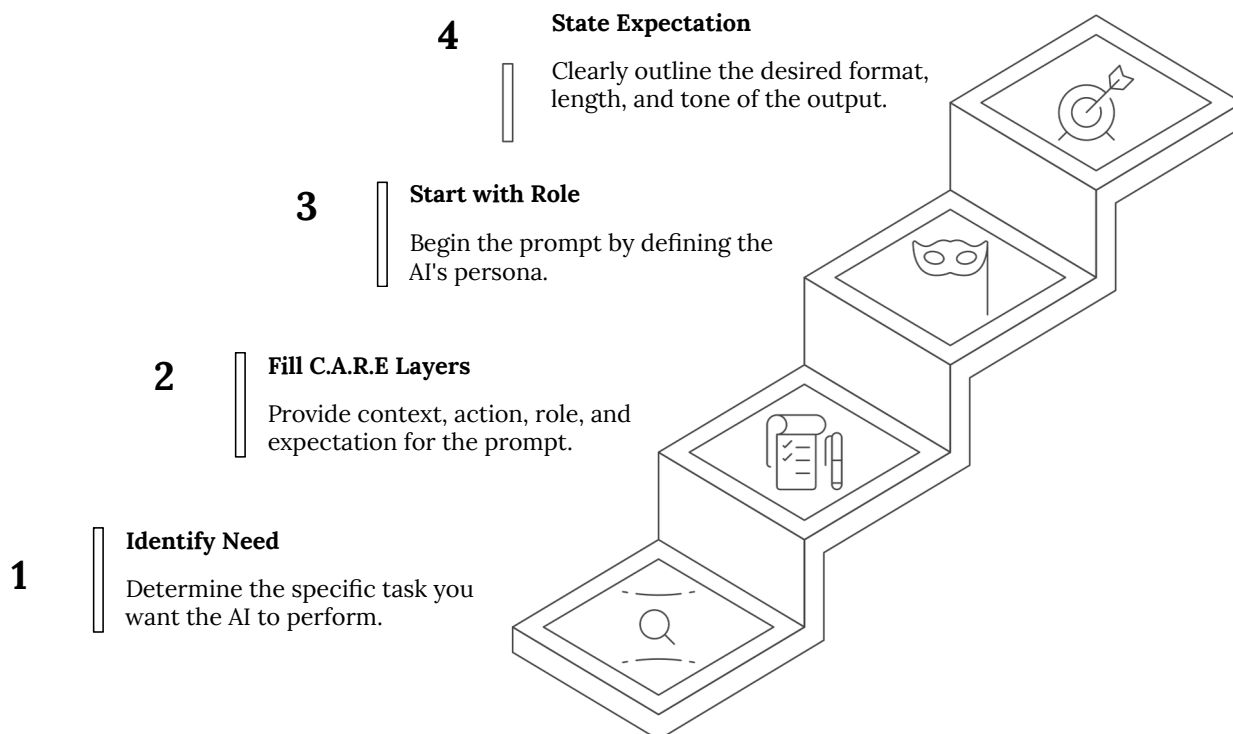
Role: Act as a [EXPERT ROLE e.g. B2B sales coach].

Context: I am [YOUR SITUATION company, stage, industry].

Action: [WHAT YOU WANT e.g. Give me 5 positioning ideas to differentiate in the [MARKET / REGION]].

Expectation: Format as a numbered list. Each point 2–3 lines.
Use plain business language. No jargon.

CRAFTING EFFECTIVE AI PROMPTS



PRO TIP

If your output feels off, the problem is almost always a vague Role or missing Expectation. Fix those two before rewriting the whole prompt.

Pairs well with: 1.2 Context Stack · 1.3 Role Prompting · 1.4 Refinement Loop

1.2 — The Context Stack

Why AI gives generic answers and how to fix it

USE THIS WHEN

Your AI outputs feel shallow or off-target even when you've explained the situation. The AI is missing crucial background that seems obvious to you.

THE FRAMEWORK

AI has no memory of who you are. Every prompt starts from zero. The Context Stack is a four-layer background brief: **Situation** (current state), **Background** (relevant history and details), **Constraints** (what limits apply), **Output Format** (exactly how you want the answer). The more precise your stack, the more precise the output.

Constraints is the layer people forget most, which is why AI often suggests things you already know won't work. Background doesn't need to be exhaustive, just the two or three facts that would change the answer if left out. A reused context stack compounds in value across a session, since each new prompt inherits the setup instead of re-explaining it

Origin: Prompt engineering best practice — adapted from AI workflow research, 2023

HOW TO USE IT

1. Write your context stack before your actual question, treat it as setup.
2. Include industry, company stage, audience, and any non-obvious constraints.
3. Reuse the same context stack across a session by pasting it at the top.
4. For recurring tasks, save your context stack as a reusable template.

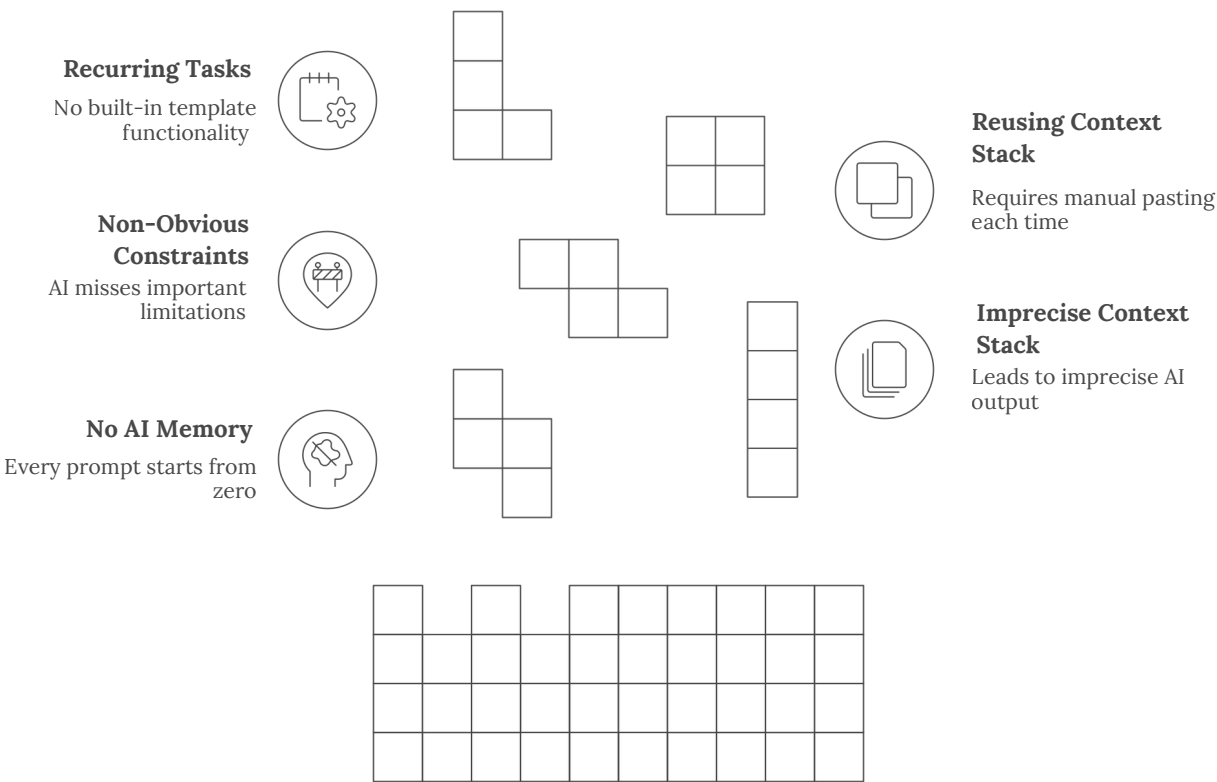
COMMON MISTAKE

Most people give AI context about what they want but not who they are, what they've already tried, or what a good result looks like. AI fills those gaps with assumptions and they're usually wrong. Stack all four layers before you prompt, not after you get a bad result.

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

- Situation** : [What is happening - current challenge or goal]
- Background** : [Industry, team size, stage, audience, product, region - whatever is relevant]
- Constraints** : [Time, budget, tone, audience level, things to avoid]
- Output format** : [List / paragraph / table / email draft]
- Now** : [YOUR ACTUAL QUESTION OR REQUEST]

AI Output Feels Shallow: Missing Context



PRO TIP

Save your most-used context stacks as text snippets. Paste them at the start of any AI session. This single habit cuts prompt iteration time by half.

Pairs well with: 1.1 C.A.R.E Prompting · 1.3 Role Prompting · 1.4 Refinement Loop

1.3 — Role Prompting - The Expert Chair

Make AI think like whoever you need it to be

USE THIS WHEN

Your AI outputs sound like a generic internet article instead of expert advice. You need the AI to reason from a specific professional perspective.

THE FRAMEWORK

When you **assign a role**, you activate a specific subset of the AI's knowledge. 'Act as a B2B sales coach' pulls very different reasoning than 'Act as a financial analyst' for the same question. The Expert Chair goes further: **assign a role, define their expertise level, and describe what outcome they care most about**. The more specific the role, the less generic the answer, since a vague expert gives a vague opinion but a precisely defined one brings actual priorities to the table.

Origin: Stanford / OpenAI research on persona-based prompting, 2022

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define the role as specifically as possible seniority and specialisation matter.
2. Add what the expert cares about most their lens shapes the output.
3. For complex decisions, run the same question with 2–3 different roles.
4. Compare outputs the gaps between expert views reveal the real insight.

IN PRACTICE

McKinsey consultants routinely run the same client question through three expert roles: CFO, Head of Sales, and a sceptical board member. The disagreements between the three answers reveal where the real risk lives. You can replicate this in under two minutes with AI at no cost.

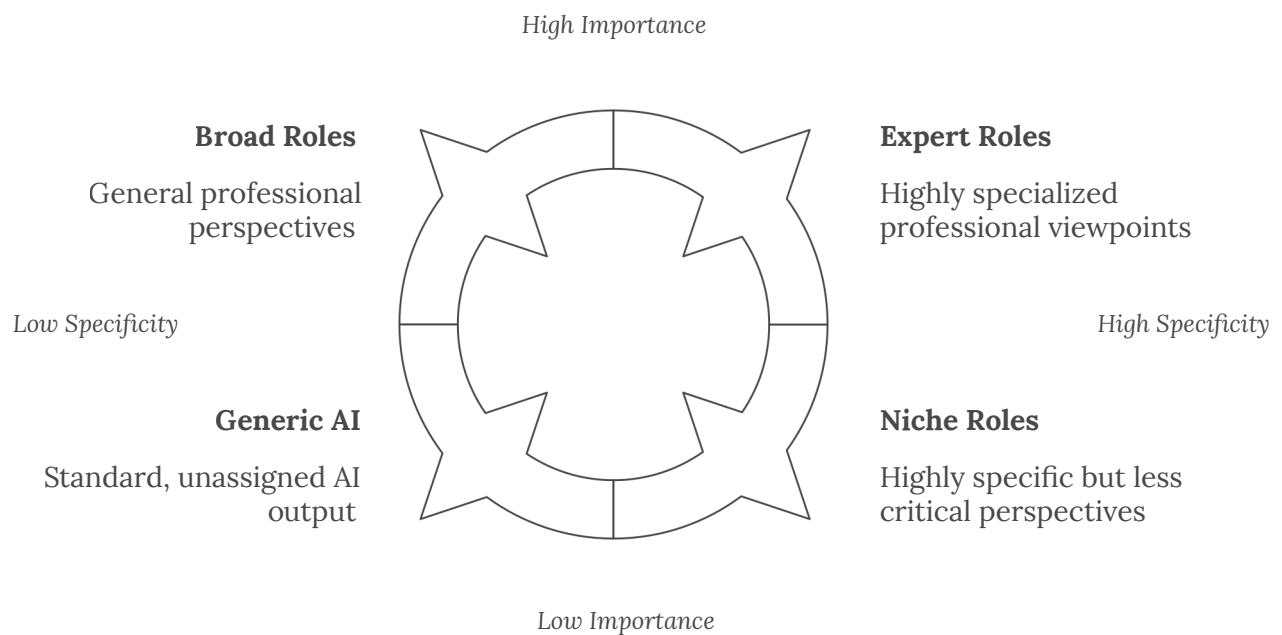
Act as a **[SPECIFIC EXPERT]** e.g. senior B2B SaaS sales strategist with 15 years selling to enterprise CTOs].

You care most about: **[THEIR PRIORITY]** - e.g. shortening sales cycles and increasing deal value, not just volume].

From your expert perspective: **[YOUR QUESTION OR SCENARIO]** - be specific]

Give your honest assessment. Flag risks I may not have considered.

Define AI Roles



PRO TIP

The most underused version: assign a role that would disagree with your plan. 'Act as a sceptical investor' or 'Act as the customer who would not buy this' reveals blind spots no internal meeting will find.

Pairs well with: 1.1 C.A.R.E · 1.5 Six Thinking Hats · 8.6 Red Team Thinking

1.4 — The Refinement Loop

Stop accepting the first output - iterate to excellence

USE THIS WHEN

You get an AI output, it's okay but not quite right, and you don't know how to improve it without starting over. You move on, leaving quality on the table.

THE FRAMEWORK

One prompt almost never produces the best result. The Refinement Loop is a four-stage iteration: **Draft** (generate first version), **Critique** (ask AI what's weak), **Improve** (ask AI to fix those weaknesses), **Lock** (confirm the final version meets your goal). Each loop takes under 60 seconds.

Most people stop at Draft. They get an output that is 70% right and move on leaving the best version unbuilt. The Critique step is the most underused: AI is surprisingly honest when asked to evaluate its own work, surfacing gaps you might not notice yourself. Two loops is almost always enough

Origin: Iterative prompt design — design thinking principles applied to LLM workflows, 2023

HOW TO USE IT

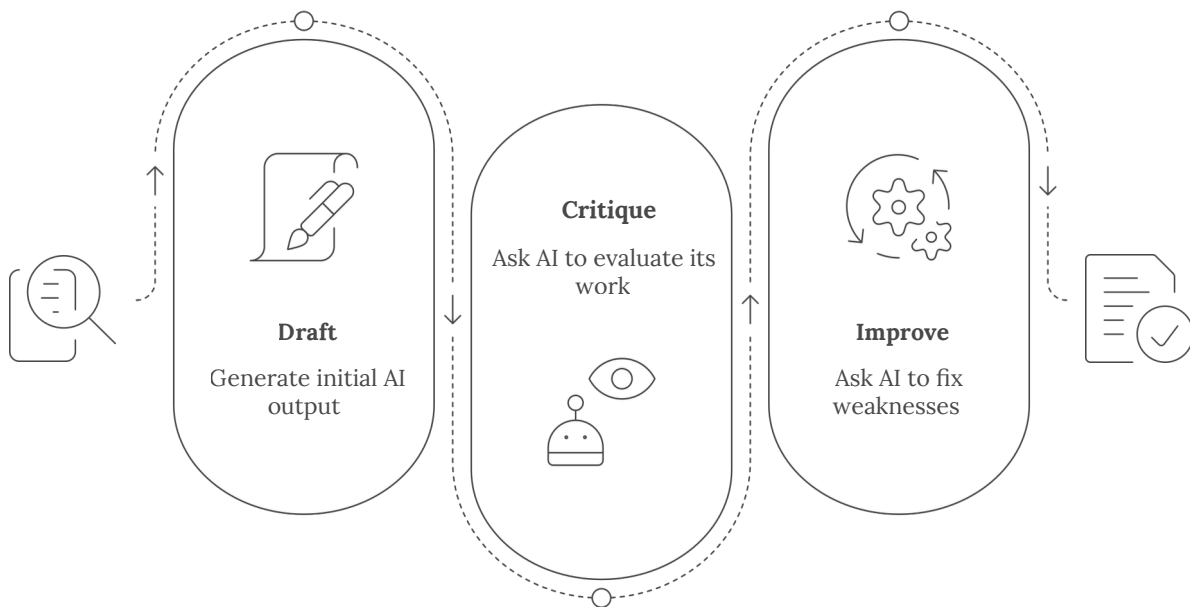
1. Generate your first draft with any reasonable prompt.
2. On the next prompt, ask AI to critique its own output specifically.
3. Ask AI to rewrite with those critiques applied.
4. Repeat once more if needed. Two loops is usually enough.

COMMON MISTAKE

Most people run the critique step, get three weaknesses, fix them then stop. They skip Step 4 (Lock). That final check is where the last 10% of quality lives, and it's also where the error you didn't notice gets caught. Two loops takes four minutes. One loop leaves quality on the table.

- Step 1** — Draft: [Paste your original prompt and generate first output]
- Step 2** — Critique: Review the response you just gave.
What are the 3 weakest parts? Where is it too vague or generic?
- Step 3** — Improve: Rewrite the original response with those 3 weaknesses fixed.
Keep what was strong. Improve what was weak.
- Step 4** — Lock: Anything that would make this significantly better?
If yes, apply it. If no, confirm this is the final version.

Achieving AI Output Excellence



PRO TIP

Use Step 2 as a standalone habit. After any important output- email, proposal, plan and ask AI 'What is the weakest part of this?' before you send it. Takes 10 seconds.

Pairs well with: 1.1 C.A.R.E · 8.2 Pre-Mortem · 4.7 Proposal Writing

1.5 — Six Thinking Hats

A complete 360-degree view of any decision or idea

USE THIS WHEN

You need to evaluate an idea, plan, or decision from every angle logic, emotion, risk, creativity, facts, and process and your team debates from fixed positions instead of structured perspectives.

THE FRAMEWORK

Created by Edward de Bono, Six Hats forces parallel thinking everyone examines the same dimension at the same time. **White Hat:** facts and data. **Red Hat:** emotions and gut reactions. **Black Hat:** risks and problems. **Yellow Hat:** benefits and upside. **Green Hat:** creative alternatives. **Blue Hat:** process and next steps. AI runs all six in a single prompt.

Origin: Edward de Bono, Six Thinking Hats, 1985

HOW TO USE IT

- 
1. Write a clear, specific description of your idea or decision.
 2. Paste the prompt and read each hat section fully never skip Black Hat.
 3. Use Green Hat output as your brainstorm starting point for next steps.
 4. For team decisions, share the output and discuss where instinct differs.

ORIGIN STORY



Edward de Bono created Six Thinking Hats in 1985 after observing that most disagreements in meetings were really people thinking in different modes simultaneously, some analysing facts, others protecting feelings, others generating ideas. Separating the modes eliminated 80% of unproductive conflict. The method is now used in over 50 countries in boardrooms and classrooms.

Act as a strategic facilitator using De Bono's Six Thinking Hats.

Topic : [YOUR DECISION OR IDEA - be specific]

White Hat : Facts and data we have or need?

Red Hat : Gut feelings and emotional reactions?

Black Hat : Risks, flaws, what could go wrong?

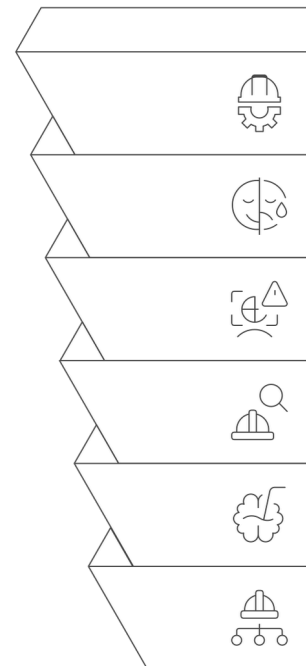
Yellow Hat : Benefits and best-case outcomes?

Green Hat : Creative alternatives and new directions?

Blue Hat : Recommended next step or process?

Give 3 specific points per hat. Be concrete, not generic.

Six Thinking Hats Process



PRO TIP

Run this twice – once for your plan, once asking AI to argue the opposite position. The gap between the two outputs is where the most useful insight is hiding.

Pairs well with: 1.6 First Principles · 8.2 Pre-Mortem · 8.6 Red Team Thinking

1.6 — First Principles Thinking

Break every assumption. Rebuild from the ground up.

USE THIS WHEN

You're stuck because you've inherited a way of doing things that nobody has questioned. Every solution is a variation of the same approach. You need a breakthrough, not an iteration.

THE FRAMEWORK

First principles means **decomposing a problem to its fundamental truths, stripping away assumptions, analogies, and 'how it's always done', then rebuilding from scratch.** Aristotle formalised it. Physicists rely on it. Founders use it to build things that shouldn't be possible by conventional thinking. Most people reason by analogy instead, copying what already exists with small variations, which is faster but caps you at incremental improvements on someone else's idea.

Origin: Aristotle — applied as business thinking by Elon Musk, popularised 2012–2018

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define the problem or current approach you want to question.
2. List every assumption embedded in that approach, write them down.
3. For each assumption, ask: is this actually true, or is it inherited?
4. Reconstruct using only the things you know to be genuinely true.

IN PRACTICE

Elon Musk used First Principles to reduce SpaceX's rocket cost by 10x. The industry assumption was that rockets cost \$65M. He asked: what do the raw materials actually cost? Carbon fibre, aluminium, titanium, copper about \$2M. SpaceX built its own rockets for \$6M. The assumption was the business model, not the physics.

Act as a first principles thinking coach.

Current approach or problem: [DESCRIBE YOUR SITUATION SPECIFICALLY]

Step 1 : List every assumption in this approach.

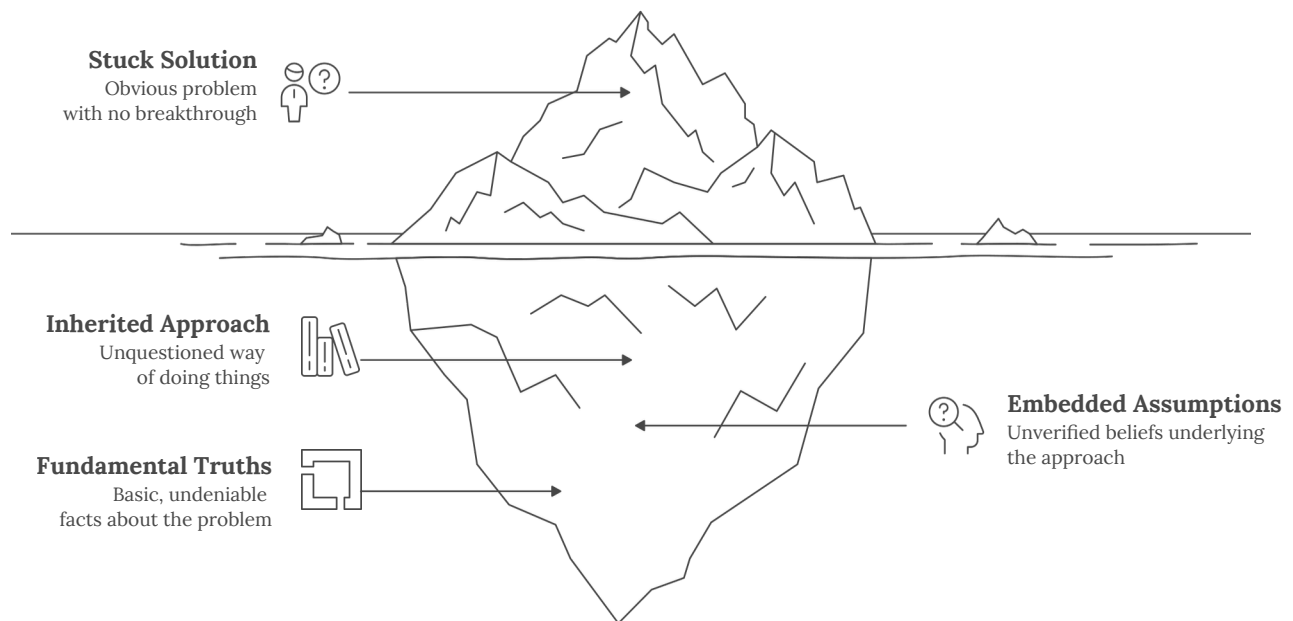
Step 2 : For each - is this actually true, or just inherited convention?

Step 3 : Which are fixed constraints vs. just habits?

Step 4 : Reconstruct a fresh approach using only what is genuinely true and necessary.

Flag the 3 most dangerous assumptions first.

FIRST PRINCIPLES THINKING: UNVEILING HIDDEN ASSUMPTIONS



PRO TIP

The most valuable output isn't the new idea, it's the list of assumptions you'd never questioned. That list alone is worth running this prompt every quarter.

Pairs well with: 1.7 Second Order · 1.8 Inversion · 2.4 Blue Ocean Strategy

1.7 — Second Order Thinking

What happens after what happens next?

USE THIS WHEN

A decision seems obviously good but you're worried about unintended consequences. Everyone agrees on the first-level outcome but nobody is thinking about what that outcome causes next.

THE FRAMEWORK

First-order thinking asks: **what happens if I do this?** Second-order thinking asks: **and then what? And then what after that?** Most bad decisions look good at the first level. The consequences that hurt you are almost always second or third order. Howard Marks popularised this in investing. It applies to every business decision.

Origin: Howard Marks, Oaktree Capital — The Most Important Thing, 2011

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define your proposed action or decision clearly.
2. Ask AI to map first, second, and third order consequences.
3. Pay special attention to negative effects of positive first-order outcomes.
4. Use the output to adjust the plan before committing resources.

QUICK CHECK

1. Have I considered how the people affected by this decision will respond and adapt, not just the immediate outcome?
2. Does my plan account for second-order effects 6 to 12 months out, not just next quarter?
3. Am I solving the visible symptom or the underlying cause that will keep producing symptoms?

Act as a strategic advisor specialising in consequence mapping.

Proposed action : [YOUR DECISION OR ACTION]

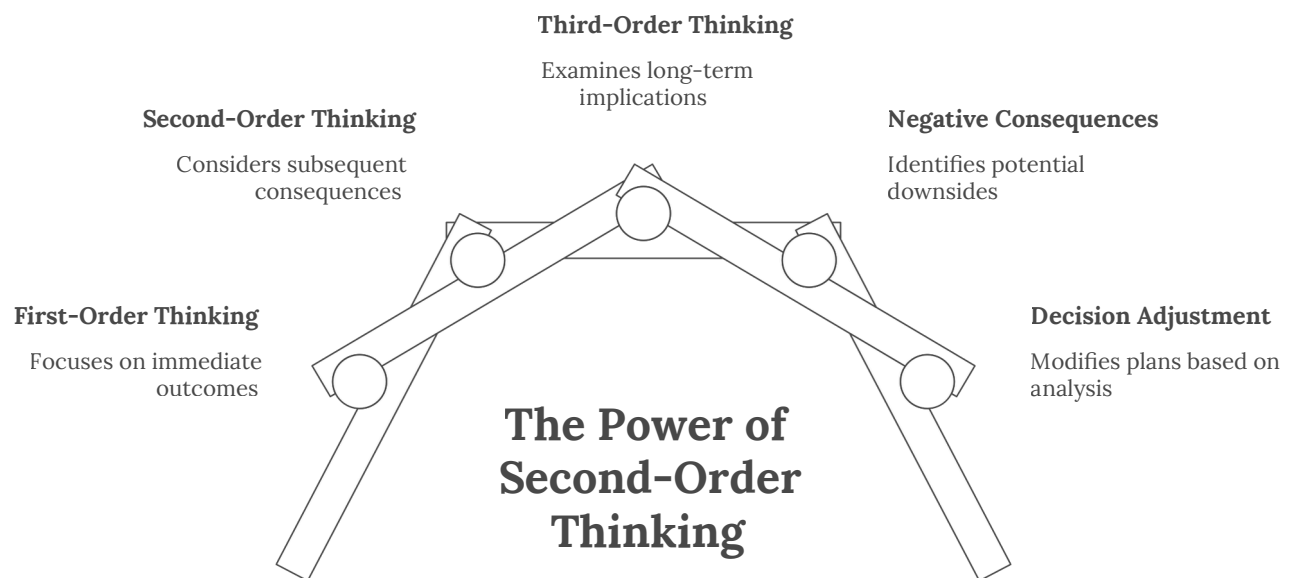
Context : [INDUSTRY, STAGE, STAKEHOLDERS AFFECTED]

1st Order : Immediate, direct effects?

2nd Order : What does each 1st-order effect then cause?

3rd Order : What does each 2nd-order effect lead to?

Flag any 2nd or 3rd order effects that could undermine the original goal even if 1st order looks positive.



PRO TIP

Don't just apply this to risky decisions. Good decisions often have harmful second-order effects that nobody maps because everyone is celebrating the first-order win.

Pairs well with: 1.8 Inversion · 8.2 Pre-Mortem · 8.4 Risk Matrix

1.8 — Inversion Thinking

What would guarantee failure? Now avoid that.

USE THIS WHEN

ou want to stress-test a plan before committing to it. Forward thinking hasn't revealed the problems. You need a completely different angle of attack.

THE FRAMEWORK

Inversion means **solving a problem backwards**. Instead of 'how do I succeed?' you ask 'what would guarantee I fail?' Then systematically avoid everything on that list. Charlie Munger called it one of the most useful thinking tools he knew. It surfaces risks that positive thinking consistently misses.

Listing paths to failure is concrete and finite, while listing paths to success is easy to fool yourself with. The founders who last usually wrote the failure list first and took it seriously.

Origin: Charlie Munger, *Poor Charlie's Almanack*, 2005

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define what you're trying to achieve be specific.
2. Ask AI to list everything that would guarantee you fail at that goal.
3. Review honestly. Cross off what you've already mitigated.
4. For everything remaining, build one prevention action each.

IN PRACTICE

Charlie Munger built Berkshire Hathaway's risk culture around inversion. Before every major investment, the team asked: 'What would guarantee we lose money here?' That list of failure conditions became the due diligence checklist. Not pessimism precision. Most investors ask 'why will this work?' Munger asked 'what would make this fail?' first.

Act as a strategic risk advisor using inversion thinking.

Goal : [WHAT I AM TRYING TO ACHIEVE be specific]

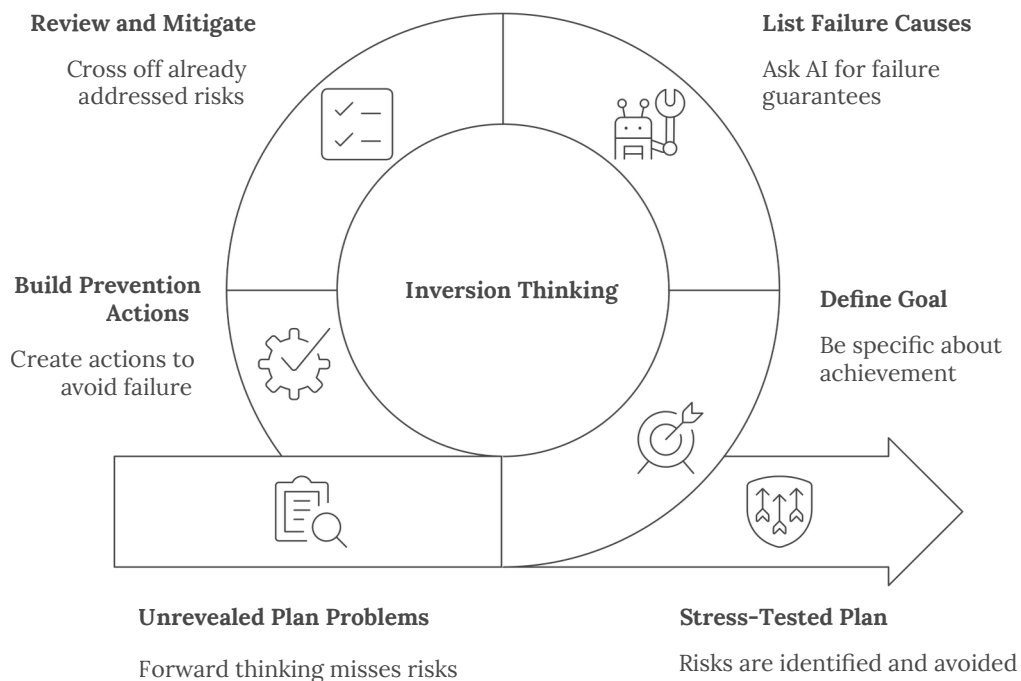
Context : [SITUATION, INDUSTRY, STAGE, TEAM]

Step 1 : List everything that would guarantee I fail. Think broadly - execution, market, team, timing, assumptions, behaviour.

Step 2 : Rank these failure causes by probability.

Step 3 : For the top 5, give one specific prevention action I can take before moving forward.

STRESS-TEST PLANS WITH INVERSION THINKING



PRO TIP

Share the failure list with your team before launch. Ask each person to add one item you missed. The combined list will contain at least one thing that would have actually stopped you and now it won't.

1.9 — Mental Models Library

The thinking lenses every leader should carry

USE THIS WHEN

You keep solving problems the same way and getting the same results. You need different lenses, proven frameworks that help you read situations faster and more accurately.

THE FRAMEWORK

A mental model is a simplified map of how something works. The best founders carry a library of them. **Pareto's 80/20** shows where leverage hides. **Parkinson's Law** explains why work expands to fill time. **Dunning-Kruger** maps confidence vs competence. **The Iceberg Model** shows what's visible vs what's driving behaviour beneath the surface. The value isn't memorizing the list, it's reaching for the right model at the right moment, the way a mechanic reaches for the right tool without thinking about the whole toolbox.

Origin: Charlie Munger / Farnam Street (Shane Parrish) — *The Great Mental Models*, 2019

HOW TO USE IT

1. Describe the challenge or situation you're trying to understand.
2. Ask AI to apply 3–5 relevant models to your specific situation.
3. Look for where two or more models point to the same root cause.
4. Build your own shortlist of 5 models you find most useful.

COMMON MISTAKE

Leaders build a mental model library and then apply the same two or three models to every problem usually the ones they learned first. The value isn't in having the models. It's in knowing which model fits this specific situation. Ask: am I choosing the right lens, or the familiar one?

Act as a mental models coach.

My situation : [DESCRIBE THE CHALLENGE OR DECISION]

Apply these models and give one specific insight each:

Pareto 80/20 : Where is the highest leverage?

Parkinson's Law : Where is time being wasted?

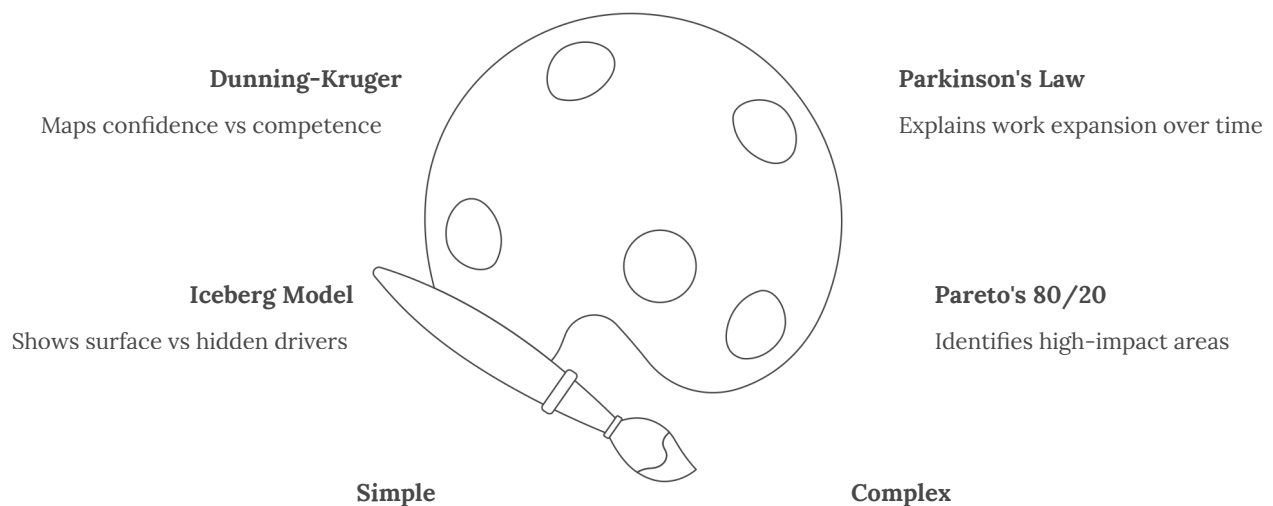
Dunning-Kruger : Where might I be overconfident?

First Principles. : What assumption am I not questioning?

Inversion : What would guarantee this fails?

Give one concrete action per model. Be direct.

MENTAL MODELS RANGE FROM SIMPLE TO COMPLEX UNDERSTANDING.



PRO TIP

After every quarter, add one new mental model you discovered and note a situation where it would have helped. In three years you'll have a thinking toolkit no one can buy.

Pairs well with: 1.5 Six Thinking Hats · 1.6 First Principles · 1.8 Inversion

1.10 — OODA Loop

Observe, Orient, Decide, Act - military speed for startup decisions

USE THIS WHEN

You're in a fast-moving competitive situation a market shift, a competitor move, a crisis and your decision-making process is too slow to keep up with what's happening.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by US Air Force Colonel John Boyd from studying aerial dogfights, the OODA Loop is a decision cycle built for speed under uncertainty. **Observe** (take in raw information), **Orient** (analyse it through your context and mental models), **Decide** (choose a course of action), **Act** (execute). The winner in any fast-changing situation is the one who cycles through OODA faster than the opposition. AI can compress the Orient phase dramatically.

Origin: John Boyd, US Air Force — OODA Loop, 1970s–1980s

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define the fast-moving situation you're inside right now.
2. Feed AI all available information, don't filter it yet, let AI orient.
3. Ask for decision options, not one answer. Keep your cycle moving.
4. After acting, immediately feed the result back in as new Observe data.

ORIGIN STORY

Boyd was considered the best fighter pilot in the US Air Force he had an open bet that from a position of disadvantage, he could defeat any opponent in under 40 seconds. He never lost. His secret was not reflexes but decision speed: he could complete a full OODA cycle faster than his opponent could react to his last move. Boyd later spent decades refining the framework, applying it to military strategy, business, and geopolitics.

Act as a strategic decision advisor using John Boyd's OODA Loop.

Situation : [DESCRIBE WHAT IS HAPPENING RIGHT NOW]

Available information : [LIST WHAT YOU KNOW , even partial data]

Constraints : [TIME AVAILABLE, RESOURCES, KEY RISKS]

Observe : What are the most critical signals in this data?

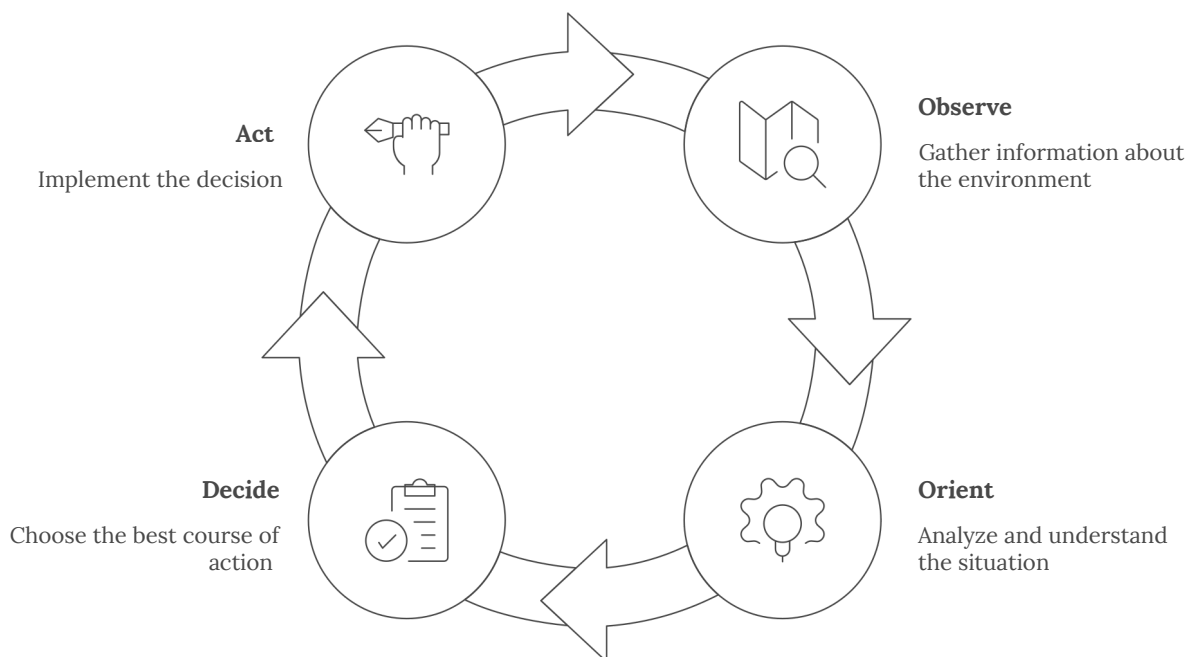
Orient : What patterns, threats, or opportunities do these reveal?

Decide : Give me 3 decision options ranked by speed and impact.

Act : For the top option, what is the immediate first move?

Prioritise speed. Flag what I should monitor after acting.

OODA LOOP – SPEED UNDER UNCERTAINTY



PRO TIP

The Orient phase is where most leaders get stuck, they have the data but can't see the pattern fast enough. That's exactly what AI compresses. Use it there, not as a replacement for your judgment on the Decide and Act stages.

Pairs well with: 1.5 Six Thinking Hats · 8.1 DECIDE Framework · 8.6 Red Team

1.11 — SCAMPER

Seven creative lenses to transform any idea

USE THIS WHEN

You need to innovate on an existing product, process, or idea but every direction feels like a variation of the same thing. You want structured creative thinking, not just brainstorming.

THE FRAMEWORK

SCAMPER is a structured creativity tool built on seven lenses: **Substitute** (what can be replaced?), **Combine** (what can be merged?), **Adapt** (what can be borrowed from elsewhere?), **Modify or Magnify** (what can be changed or amplified?), **Put to other uses** (what else could this do?), **Eliminate** (what can be removed?), **Reverse or Rearrange** (what if we flipped the order?). Each lens forces a different angle on the same problem. Originally developed by Bob Eberle, building on Alex Osborn's brainstorming work.

Origin: Bob Eberle, SCAMPER, 1971 — based on Alex Osborn's brainstorming work, 1953

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define the product, process, or idea you want to innovate on.
2. Ask AI to apply all seven SCAMPER lenses to your specific situation.
3. Look for combinations, often the best idea comes from two lenses together.
4. Select the 2–3 most viable directions and develop them further.

QUICK CHECK

1. Have I applied SCAMPER to the constraint itself, not just the product or service?
2. Which of the seven lenses am I most likely to skip because it feels too radical?
3. Would my best competitor use one of these moves to disrupt me if I don't use it first?

Act as a creative innovation facilitator using SCAMPER.

I want to innovate on : [YOUR PRODUCT, SERVICE, OR PROCESS]

Context : [INDUSTRY, TARGET CUSTOMER, CURRENT LIMITATIONS]

Substitute : What component or step could be replaced?

Combine : What could be merged for more value?

Adapt : What works elsewhere that I could borrow?

Modify : What could be changed, enlarged, or reduced?

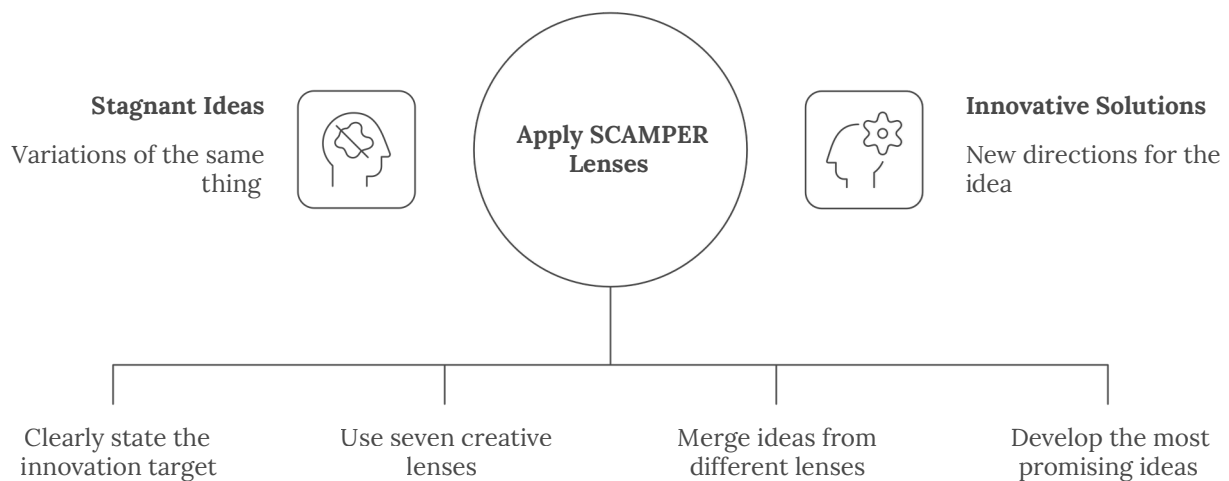
Put to other uses : What other jobs could this do?

Eliminate : What could be removed entirely?

Reverse : What if the order or direction was flipped?

Give one specific, actionable idea per lens.

SCAMPER: Structured Creativity for Innovation



PRO TIP

Run SCAMPER on your competitors' products, not just your own. Ask 'what would happen if a competitor applied SCAMPER to our product?' The answers will tell you your vulnerabilities before they do.

Pairs well with: 1.6 First Principles · 2.4 Blue Ocean Strategy · 1.9 Mental Models

1.12 — MECE Framework

Structure any problem so nothing overlaps and nothing is missed

USE THIS WHEN

You're presenting an analysis, making a recommendation, or solving a complex problem and your thinking feels incomplete, repetitive, or hard to follow. You need a structure that is airtight.

THE FRAMEWORK

MECE stands for Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive. It is a McKinsey core thinking principle. **Mutually Exclusive** means every category is distinct, no overlap. **Collectively Exhaustive** means together the categories cover everything, no gaps. When your problem breakdown is **MECE**, your analysis is complete, your communication is clear, and your solution covers all the ground. AI can test whether your structure is MECE and help rebuild it if it isn't.

Origin: McKinsey & Company — core consulting methodology, attributed to Barbara Minto, 1960s

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define the problem or decision you need to structure.
2. Ask AI to break it into MECE categories and check for overlaps or gaps.
3. Use the MECE structure as your analysis framework and your presentation outline.
4. Apply MECE to any situation where you need to be sure nothing is missed.

ORIGIN STORY

Barbara Minto created MECE at McKinsey in the 1960s to solve a specific problem: consultant reports were being rejected because the logic had gaps or overlaps. She codified the principle that categories must not repeat (mutually exclusive) and together must cover everything (collectively exhaustive). It became the backbone of all McKinsey output and the standard for structured thinking in consulting globally.

Act as a McKinsey-trained strategy consultant.

Problem or question to structure: [YOUR PROBLEM, DECISION, OR ANALYSIS TOPIC]

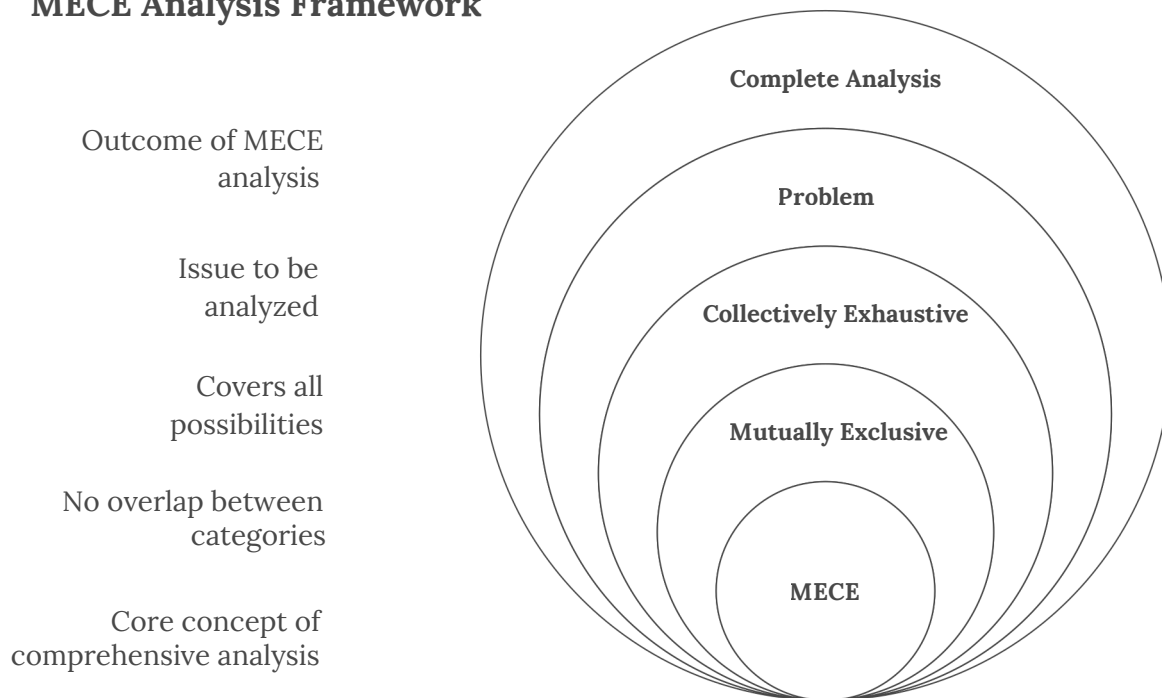
Step 1 : Break this into MECE categories. Each category must be distinct, no overlap. Together they must cover everything, no gaps.

Step 2 : Check your structure. Flag any overlaps or missing areas.

Step 3 : For each category, list the 2–3 key questions I need to answer to address it completely.

Format as a structured outline I can use directly.

MECE Analysis Framework



PRO TIP

MECE is not just for analysis use it to structure any important communication. Before a board presentation or investor meeting, ask AI to check if your argument is MECE. Incomplete structure is the most common reason smart people fail to persuade.

Pairs well with: 1.9 Mental Models · 8.1 DECIDE Framework · 9.5 Investor Narrative

MODULE 2

Design Your Business

Shape what you're building so it deserves to exist.

WHAT THIS MODULE DOES

Most founders skip from idea to execution without ever properly designing the business. They build the wrong thing efficiently. This module gives you the tools to validate your model, understand your customer deeply, find uncontested market space, and price with confidence before you spend a year building something the market doesn't want.

IN THIS MODULE

- 2.1 Value Proposition Canvas
- 2.2 Business Model Canvas
- 2.3 Lean Canvas
- 2.4 Blue Ocean Strategy
- 2.5 Jobs To Be Done
- 2.6 MVP Design
- 2.7 Pricing Strategy — Value Ladder
- 2.8 Unfair Advantage — Moat Builder
- 2.9 Ansoff Matrix
- 2.10 Kano Model

Start here if you are new to AI, or your prompts feel hit-or-miss.

2.1 — Value Proposition Canvas

Make sure your product solves a real problem, not one you imagined

USE THIS WHEN

You're not sure if your product genuinely solves a problem people care about, or you're getting objections like 'we already do that another way' or 'we don't really need this.'

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Alexander Osterwalder, the Value Proposition Canvas maps two things side by side: your **Customer Profile** (what jobs they're trying to do, what pains they experience, what gains they want) and your **Value Map** (your products and services, pain relievers, gain creators). **Product-market fit** happens when your Value Map directly addresses the most important items in the Customer Profile. Most product failures happen because founders built the Value Map first, then looked for customers to match.

The canvas works best as a living document, not a one-time exercise. As you talk to customers, your understanding of their jobs and pains sharpens and your Value Map should shift to match. A canvas that never changes after the first draft is a sign that no real customer conversation has happened yet.

Origin: Alexander Osterwalder, Value Proposition Design, 2014

HOW TO USE IT

- 
1. Fill in the Customer Profile first before touching the Value Map.
 2. Focus on the top 3 pains and top 3 gains that matter most to the customer.
 3. Map each feature of your product to a specific pain or gain if it doesn't map, question why it exists.
 4. Look for gaps: pains with no reliever, or gains with no creator those are your next features.

Act as a product-market fit consultant.

My product / service : [DESCRIBE WHAT YOU OFFER]

Target customer : [SPECIFIC ROLE, INDUSTRY, COMPANY SIZE]

CUSTOMER PROFILE:

Jobs : What are they trying to accomplish – functional, social, and emotional jobs?

Pains : What frustrates them, costs them, or risks them?

Gains : What outcomes and benefits do they want?

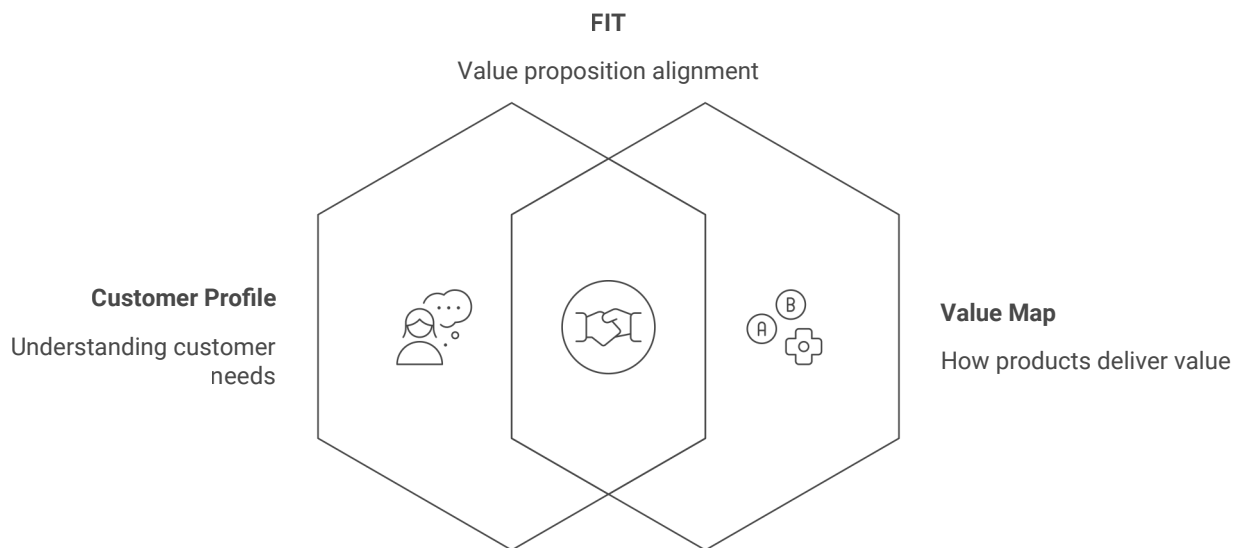
VALUE MAP:

Pain Relievers : How does my product address each pain?

Gain Creators : How does it deliver the gains they want?

Fit Score : Where is the match strong? Where are the gaps?

Identify the top 3 pains I am NOT addressing. Tell me what to build or change first.



PRO TIP

Ask AI to fill in the Customer Profile as if it were your most sceptical potential customer not your ideal one. The gap between the ideal profile and the sceptical one is exactly where your messaging and product need to improve.

Pairs well with: 2.5 JTBD · 3.4 ICP · 3.8 Voice of Customer · 2.3 Lean Canvas

2.2 — Business Model Canvas

Map your entire business on one page

USE THIS WHEN

You need to communicate your business model clearly to a co-founder, investor, or team member or you want to stress-test whether all nine elements of your business actually work together.

THE FRAMEWORK

Created by Alexander Osterwalder, the Business Model Canvas maps a business across nine building blocks: **Customer Segments, Value Propositions, Channels, Customer Relationships, Revenue Streams, Key Resources, Key Activities, Key Partnerships, and Cost Structure**. When completed, it shows you whether your model is internally coherent and where the weakest links are. It's the fastest way to see your whole business in one view.

Origin: Alexander Osterwalder & Yves Pigneur, Business Model Generation, 2010

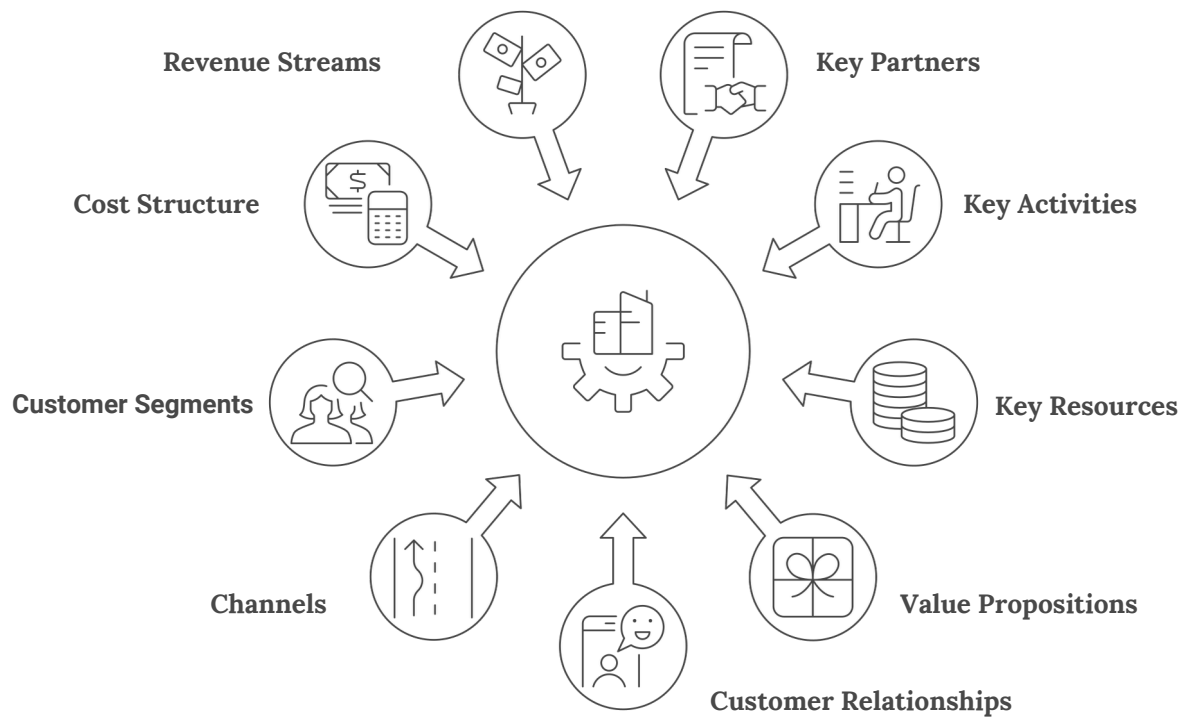
HOW TO USE IT

1. Complete the Canvas in this order: Customer Segments fi Value Propositions fi Channels fi Revenue. Fill the left side (Resources, Activities, Partners, Costs) last.
2. For each block, ask: does this connect logically to the blocks beside it?
3. Identify the two blocks with the most assumptions, those are your biggest risks.
4. Redo the Canvas after any major pivot to check if the model is still coherent.

IN PRACTICE

When Airbnb mapped its Business Model Canvas in 2009, its founders realised they were actually running two separate businesses — one serving hosts, one serving guests with completely different value propositions and cost structures. Recognising this prevented them from confusing the two models and helped them identify which customer segment to optimise first.

BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS



AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a business model strategist using Osterwalder's Business Model Canvas.

My business: [DESCRIBE WHAT YOUR COMPANY DOES]

Stage: [PRE-REVENUE / EARLY REVENUE / SCALING]

Map all nine blocks for my business:

- | | |
|-----------------------|---------------------|
| 1. Customer Segments | 6. Key Resources |
| 2. Value Propositions | 7. Key Activities |
| 3. Channels | 8. Key Partnerships |
| 4. Customer Relations | 9. Cost Structure |
| 5. Revenue Streams | |

After mapping: identify the 2 weakest blocks and explain what I need to validate or strengthen in each.

Pairs well with: 2.3 Lean Canvas · 2.1 Value Proposition · 2.8 Moat Builder

2.3 — Lean Canvas

Validate fast before you build the wrong thing

USE THIS WHEN

You're pre-revenue and need to validate quickly. You don't need a full business plan, you need to identify your riskiest assumptions and test them before spending months building.

THE FRAMEWORK

Ash Maurya adapted the Business Model Canvas into the Lean Canvas specifically for startups. It replaces the left-side partnership and activity blocks with **Problem, Solution, Key Metrics, and Unfair Advantage**, the four things that matter most before product-market fit. The Lean Canvas is designed to be completed in one sitting and updated as you learn. Think of it as a living hypothesis, not a fixed plan.

Origin: Ash Maurya, Running Lean, 2012 — adapted from Osterwalder's BMC

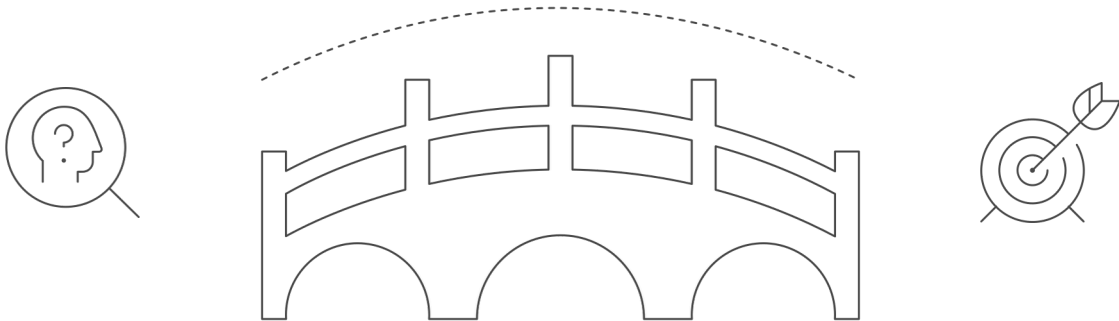
HOW TO USE IT

1. Complete the Problem block first - if you can't describe the problem sharply, stop here.
2. Write your Unfair Advantage honestly - if you can't fill this in yet, that's important information.
3. Mark the two most uncertain blocks - those are your first two things to validate.
4. Update the Canvas after every 5 customer conversations.

COMMON MISTAKE

Founders fill in the Lean Canvas once at the beginning, then never update it. The canvas is a live document, it should change every time a core assumption is tested and proven wrong. A canvas that hasn't changed in three months usually means the founder isn't talking to customers enough.

LEAN CANVAS BRIDGES THE GAP FROM ASSUMPTIONS TO PRODUCT-MARKET FIT.



Risky Assumptions

Unvalidated ideas
hinder progress.

Product-Market Fit

Validated ideas drive
successful product
development.

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a lean startup advisor using Ash Maurya's Lean Canvas.

My startup idea : [DESCRIBE IN 2-3 SENTENCES]

Target customer : [WHO IS THE EARLY ADOPTER SPECIFICALLY]

Complete all nine blocks:

1. Problem (top 3 problems being solved)
2. Customer Segment (early adopters specifically)
3. Unique Value Prop (clear, compelling, different)
4. Solution (top 3 features or capabilities)
5. Channels (how you reach customers)
6. Revenue Streams (how you charge)
7. Cost Structure (key costs)
8. Key Metrics (the number that shows traction)
9. Unfair Advantage (what can't be easily copied)

Then: flag the 2 highest-risk assumptions to validate first.

Pairs well with: 2.1 Value Proposition · 2.6 MVP Design · 2.8 Moat Builder

2.4 — Blue Ocean Strategy

Stop competing. Make the competition irrelevant.

USE THIS WHEN

You're operating in a market where everyone is fighting over the same customers with similar products, and the only lever you have is price. You need to find or create a space where you're not compared.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by W. Chan Kim and Renée Mauborgne, Blue Ocean Strategy distinguishes between **Red Oceans** (existing markets: bloody with competition) and **Blue Oceans** (new market spaces, uncontested). The core tool is the **Eliminate-Reduce-Raise-Create grid (ERRC)**: what can you eliminate that your industry takes for granted? What can you reduce below industry standard? What should be raised above it? What should be created that has never been offered? The result is a value curve that looks nothing like your competitors.

The ERRC grid forces a trade-off most businesses avoid: you cannot raise everything. Every Raise requires an Eliminate to fund it. That discipline is what separates a genuine Blue Ocean move from a feature list. Most founders fill in Create and Raise easily but stall on Eliminate, because giving something up feels like admitting weakness rather than making a strategic choice. The businesses that actually reshape their category are the ones willing to look incomplete by old industry standards on purpose.

Origin: W. Chan Kim & Renée Mauborgne, *Blue Ocean Strategy*, 2004

HOW TO USE IT

1. Map what your industry currently competes on price, features, service, speed.
2. Apply the ERRC grid to find where you can break the value-cost trade-off.
3. Look for non-customers, people who don't use any existing solution. They define your Blue Ocean.
4. Test your new value curve: is it focused, divergent, and does it have a compelling tagline?

Act as a Blue Ocean Strategy consultant.

My industry : [NAME THE INDUSTRY AND KEY PLAYERS]

My current product / service : [BRIEF DESCRIPTION]

Step 1 – Map the current competitive factors in my industry.

Step 2 – Apply the ERRC Grid:

ELIMINATE : What factors can I remove entirely?

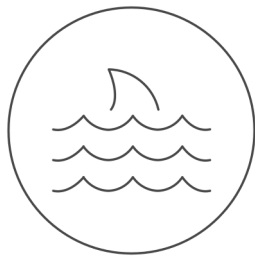
REDUCE : What can I offer below industry standard?

RAISE : What should I offer above industry standard?

CREATE : What new value can I introduce that doesn't exist
anywhere in the industry?

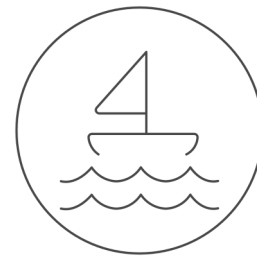
Step 3 – Describe the Blue Ocean this creates and who the new target customer would be.

How to achieve market differentiation?



Red Ocean

Intense competition and price wars



Blue Ocean

Uncontested market space

PRO TIP

The best Blue Oceans are often found by looking at the non-customers of your industry, people who don't buy from anyone. Ask AI: 'Who refuses to use any solution in this market and why?' Their reasons are your roadmap.

Pairs well with: 2.8 Moat Builder · 3.3 Porter's Five Forces · 1.6 First Principles

2.5 — Jobs To Be Done

Understand the real reason customers buy, not what they say

USE THIS WHEN

Your customers describe your product differently than you do. Your retention is lower than it should be. People churn and you don't understand why. You're optimising features nobody really cares about.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Clayton Christensen at Harvard Business School, Jobs To Be Done (**JTBD**) is a lens for understanding why customers 'hire' a product. People don't buy products, they hire them to do a job. That job has three layers: a **Functional job** (the practical task), a **Social job** (how they want to be seen doing it), and an **Emotional job** (how they want to feel). The product that best does all three layers of the job wins. Most products only address the functional layer.

Origin: Clayton Christensen, Harvard Business School — JTBD theory, 1990s–2000s

HOW TO USE IT

1. Interview 5 real customers using the JTBD prompt below, don't survey, talk.
2. Focus on the moment they decided to look for a solution, that's where the real job lives.
3. Map the three job layers for your product: functional, social, emotional.
4. Check your marketing: does it speak to all three layers or only the functional one?

IN PRACTICE

When Spotify analysed why users churned, the job wasn't 'listen to music' it was 'fill the silence during my commute.' That insight shifted their focus toward playlist curation and seamless playback. They stopped competing on catalogue size and started competing on moment.

Act as a Jobs To Be Done research analyst.

My product : [DESCRIBE WHAT YOUR PRODUCT DOES]

Customer type : [SPECIFIC ROLE AND CONTEXT]

For this customer, identify:

FUNCTIONAL JOB : What practical task are they hiring my product to do?

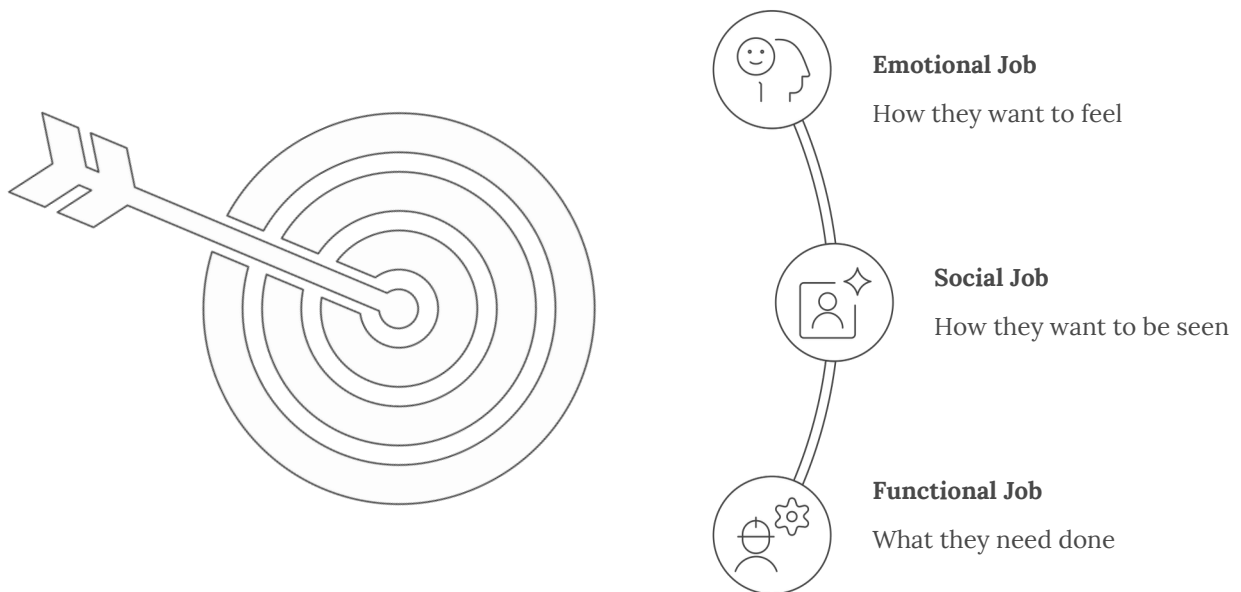
SOCIAL JOB : How do they want to be seen by others when using this product?

EMOTIONAL JOB : How do they want to feel when the job is done?

COMPETING JOBS : What else do they currently hire to do this job, including non-obvious alternatives?

Where is my product strongest and weakest across layers?

JOBS TO BE DONE – THE THREE LAYERS OF WHY



PRO TIP

The competing jobs answer is the most valuable. When a customer churns, they don't leave for nothing they hire something else to do the job. Ask AI to map the most likely 'competitor hires' for your product. The answer will surprise you.

Pairs well with: 2.1 Value Proposition · 3.4 ICP · 3.8 Voice of Customer

2.6 — MVP Design

The smallest valuable thing you can ship and learn from

USE THIS WHEN

You're about to spend months building a complete product before getting any customer feedback. You want to launch something real without building everything first, but you're not sure what to cut and what to keep.

THE FRAMEWORK

The Minimum Viable Product concept, popularised by Eric Ries in *The Lean Startup*, is about finding the smallest version of your product that delivers enough value to attract early customers and generate real learning. **MVP does not mean low quality, it means maximum learning for minimum investment.** The question is not 'what is the smallest thing we can build?' but '**what is the smallest thing that will tell us if we're right?**'

Origin: Eric Ries, *The Lean Startup*, 2011

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define the one core assumption your business depends on most.
2. Design an MVP that tests specifically that assumption, not all assumptions.
3. Set your learning criteria before building: what result would confirm or deny the assumption?
4. After shipping, treat every customer interaction as data, not validation.

IN PRACTICE

Dropbox never built the product first. They made a three-minute demo video showing how it would work and posted it online. Overnight signups went from 5,000 to 75,000. The MVP was a video, not code. They validated the assumption people want effortless file syncing, before writing a single line.

Act as a lean startup product advisor.

My business idea : [DESCRIBE IN 2-3 SENTENCES]

Core assumption : [THE ONE THING THAT MUST BE TRUE FOR THIS BUSINESS TO WORK]

Step 1 : What is the smallest product or experiment that tests this specific assumption?

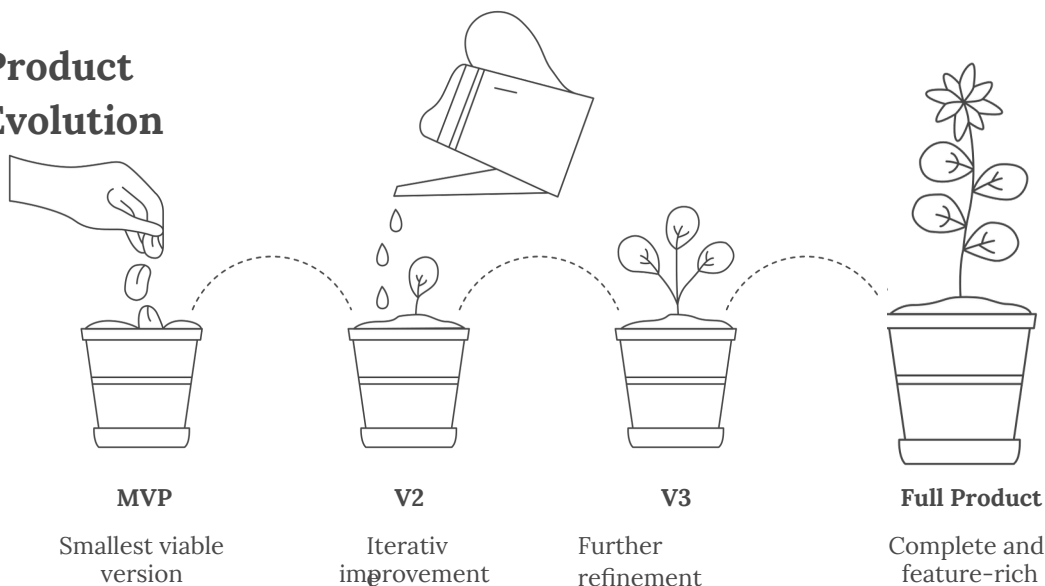
Step 2 : What does success look like? Define the metric or signal that confirms the assumption.

Step 3 : What does failure look like? What result would tell me to pivot or stop?

Step 4 : What is the fastest way to build or simulate this MVP, even without writing code?

Be specific. Avoid suggesting a full product build.

Product Evolution



PRO TIP

The most common MVP mistake is testing too many assumptions at once. One MVP, one assumption. If it passes, move to the next assumption. Running MVP tests in sequence is faster than building a complete product that tests them all at once and fails without telling you which assumption was wrong.

Pairs well with: 2.3 Lean Canvas · 2.1 Value Proposition · 3.8 Voice of Customer

2.7 — Pricing Strategy - Value Ladder

Move customers from free to premium through a logical sequence of value

USE THIS WHEN

You're leaving money on the table because all your customers pay the same price regardless of how much they use or value your product. Or you're struggling to convert free users to paying ones.

THE FRAMEWORK

The Value Ladder is a pricing architecture where you offer a sequence of increasingly valuable products or services at ascending price points. **Each level delivers genuine value and naturally** leads the customer to want the next. Russell Brunson popularised this in digital products; it applies equally to B2B services, SaaS, and physical products. The goal is to have an offer at every level of customer readiness and budget from free entry to high-ticket.

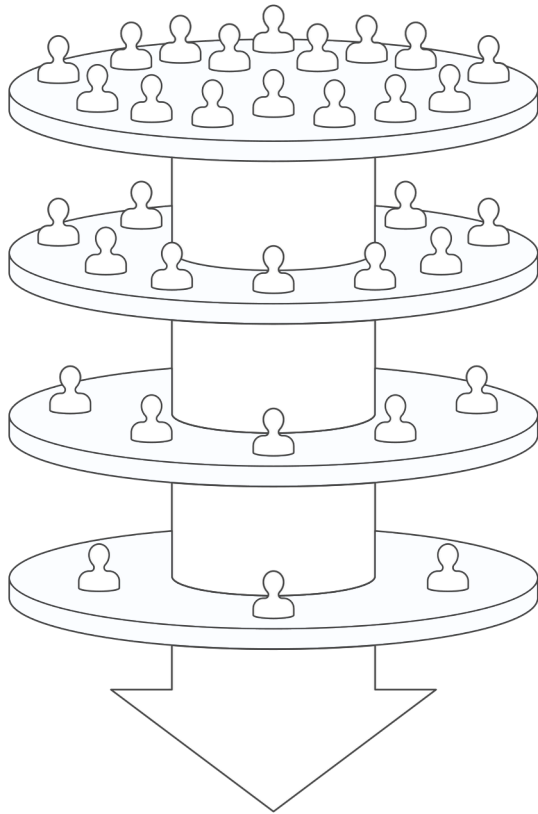
Origin: Russell Brunson, DotCom Secrets, 2015 — value ladder pricing concept

HOW TO USE IT

1. Map your current offers and identify the gaps in your value ladder.
2. Define the transformation or outcome delivered at each price tier.
3. Ensure each tier creates genuine desire for the next, not artificial restriction.
4. Price each tier based on the value delivered, not the cost to produce.

PRO TIP

Most founders price at Tier 3 and offer nothing above it. Every business should have a Tier 4 - even if only 2% of customers buy it, it will often represent 20–30% of revenue. Ask AI to design a high-ticket offer for your business before you decide you don't have one.



The Value Ladder



Free/Entry



Low-Ticket



Mid-Ticket



High-Ticket

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a pricing strategist specialising in value-based pricing.

My business : [DESCRIBE YOUR PRODUCT OR SERVICE]

Target customer : [WHO THEY ARE AND WHAT THEY WANT]

Current pricing : [WHAT YOU CHARGE NOW, IF ANYTHING]

Design a 4-tier Value Ladder for my business:

TIER 1 – FREE / LOW COST: What delivers enough value to build trust?

TIER 2 – ENTRY OFFER: First paid step – low friction, clear quick win

TIER 3 – CORE OFFER: Main product – full transformation delivered

TIER 4 – PREMIUM / HIGH TICKET: Maximum outcome – for customers who want more

For each tier : define the offer, price range, and the one outcome that makes the customer want the next tier.

Pairs well with: 2.3 Lean Canvas · 2.1 Value Proposition · 5.6 GTM Canvas

2.8 — Unfair Advantage, Moat Builder

Identify what protects you that competitors cannot easily copy

USE THIS WHEN

A competitor launches something similar. An investor asks 'what stops someone from copying this?' You don't have a clear, confident answer. Your business is growing but feels fragile.

THE FRAMEWORK

Warren Buffett's concept of an economic moat describes a sustainable competitive advantage that protects a business from competition the way a moat protects a castle. The five types of moat are: **Network Effects** (the product gets better as more people use it), **Cost Advantage** (you produce at lower cost than anyone), **Switching Costs** (customers are locked in by habit, data, or integrations), **Intangible Assets** (brands, patents, licences), and **Efficient Scale** (a market so small only one player can profitably serve it). Most businesses have weak or no moats. Building one is a strategic choice.

Origin: Warren Buffett, Berkshire Hathaway annual letters — moat concept, 1980s onwards

HOW TO USE IT

1. Identify which of the five moat types you currently have, be honest.
2. Rate each on a scale of 1–5 for strength. Anything below 3 is not a real moat.
3. Identify which moat type is most achievable given your current position.
4. Build moat-widening into your product and business roadmap deliberately.

IN PRACTICE

Amazon's unfair advantage wasn't its website, it was the proprietary logistics infrastructure it built over 15 years. When AWS launched, Amazon was already operating data centres at a scale no competitor could match affordably. The moat wasn't the product. It was the underlying capability that took a decade and billions to build and that no startup could replicate quickly.

Act as a competitive strategy advisor focused on economic moats.

My business : [DESCRIBE WHAT YOU DO AND WHO YOU SERVE]

Stage : [REVENUE STAGE - PRE / EARLY / SCALING]

Assess my moat across all five types:

NETWORK EFFECTS : Does value increase with more users?

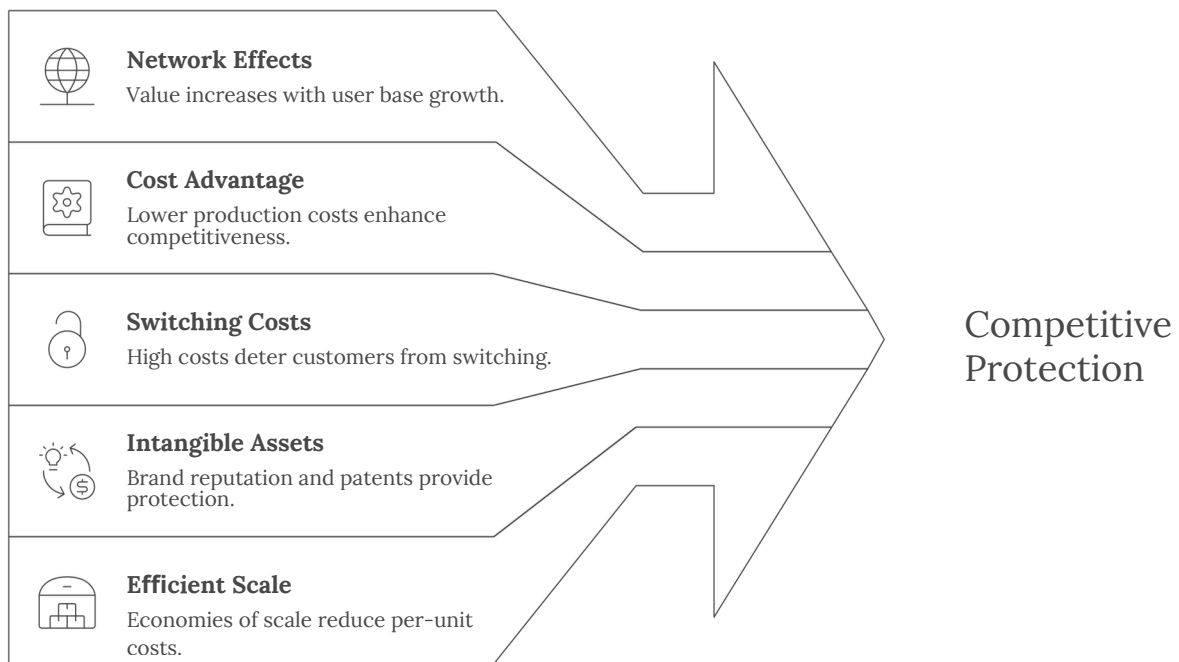
COST ADVANTAGE : Can I produce cheaper than competitors?

SWITCHING COSTS : How painful is it for customers to leave?

INTANGIBLE ASSETS : Do I have brand, IP, or licence advantages?

EFFICIENT SCALE : Am I in a market too small for competition?

Rate each 1–5. Identify my strongest moat and the fastest moat I could build from my current position. Give 2 specific actions to widen my strongest moat.



PRO TIP

Network effects are the most powerful moat but the hardest to build. If your product has any element where more users create more value even indirectly, design your product and go-to-market specifically to accelerate that loop. Most founders have a network effect they don't know they have.

Pairs well with: 2.4 Blue Ocean · 3.3 Porter's Five Forces · 2.3 Lean Canvas

2.9 — Ansoff Matrix

Find the right growth direction before committing resources

USE THIS WHEN

Your core business is working and you're ready to grow but you're unsure whether to go deeper with existing customers, expand to new markets, launch new products, or do something entirely new. Every direction feels possible and none feels obvious.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Igor Ansoff and published in Harvard Business Review in 1957, the Ansoff Matrix maps four growth strategies against two dimensions: existing vs new products, and existing vs new markets. **Market Penetration** (existing product, existing market) is lowest risk. **Market Development** (existing product, new market) and **Product Development** (new product, existing market) are medium risk. **Diversification** (new product, new market) is highest risk. Most businesses underinvest in penetration and over-invest in diversification.

Origin: Igor Ansoff, Harvard Business Review — Strategies for Diversification, 1957

HOW TO USE IT

1. Map your current position on the matrix honestly.
2. For each quadrant, estimate the level of investment and risk required.
3. Start with Market Penetration most businesses have not fully captured their existing market.
4. Only move to Diversification after the other three quadrants are saturated.

IN PRACTICE

Amazon spent seven years dominating book retail before expanding to electronics, then all products, then cloud services. Each move followed the Ansoff sequence: penetrate first, develop markets second, diversify last. The discipline of exhausting one quadrant before entering the next is what made each expansion defensible.

Act as a growth strategy advisor using the Ansoff Matrix.

My current business : [DESCRIBE PRODUCT AND MARKET]

Current stage : [REVENUE, TEAM SIZE, KEY MARKETS]

Growth objective : [WHAT YOU WANT TO ACHIEVE IN 12–24 MONTHS]

Analyse all four Ansoff quadrants for my situation:

MARKET PENETRATION : How much more can I extract from existing product + existing market?

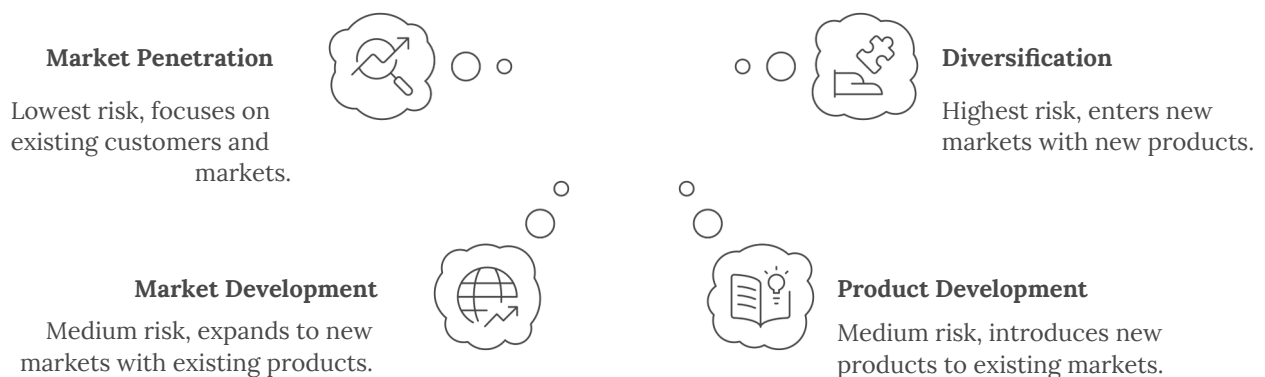
MARKET DEVELOPMENT : Which new markets could my current product serve with minimum change?

PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT : What new products could I offer to my existing customers?

DIVERSIFICATION : Where is new product + new market justified by strategic opportunity?

Recommend the highest-leverage quadrant for my stage.

Which growth strategy should we pursue?



PRO TIP

Before looking at new markets or new products, ask AI to run a full Market Penetration analysis on your existing business. Most companies at under 20% market share have significant penetration opportunity they haven't fully activated. Penetration is always cheaper than acquisition of new markets.

Pairs well with: 2.4 Blue Ocean · 2.2 Business Model Canvas · 3.5 TAM SAM SOM

2.10 — Kano Model

Understand what truly delights customers and what just keeps them from leaving

USE THIS WHEN

You're adding features and your product satisfaction scores aren't improving. Customers say they want something but when you build it, it doesn't seem to move the needle. You're not sure where to invest next.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Professor Noriaki Kano at Tokyo University of Science in 1984, the Kano Model classifies product features into three types: **Basic Needs** (expected, their absence causes dissatisfaction but their presence goes unnoticed), **Performance Needs** (more is better these features directly drive satisfaction), and **Excitement Needs** (unexpected, their presence delights, their absence is not missed). Features also evolve over time: today's excitement becomes tomorrow's basic need. AI can help you classify your features and decide where to invest.

Origin: Noriaki Kano, Tokyo University of Science — Kano Model, 1984

HOW TO USE IT

1. List all your current and planned features before prompting.
2. Classify each feature honestly, most teams overestimate how many are Excitement features.
3. Ensure Basic Needs are fully met before investing in Excitement features.
4. Identify features that used to be Excitement and have become Basic these must be flawless.



Most teams skip Basic Needs and invest in Excitement features, then wonder why satisfaction scores don't move. A delighted customer who hits a broken basic feature will churn regardless.

Act as a product strategy advisor using the Kano Model.

My product : [DESCRIBE WHAT IT DOES]

Target customer : [WHO USES IT AND IN WHAT CONTEXT]

I will list my features. Classify each as:

BASIC NEED : Expected – absence causes frustration

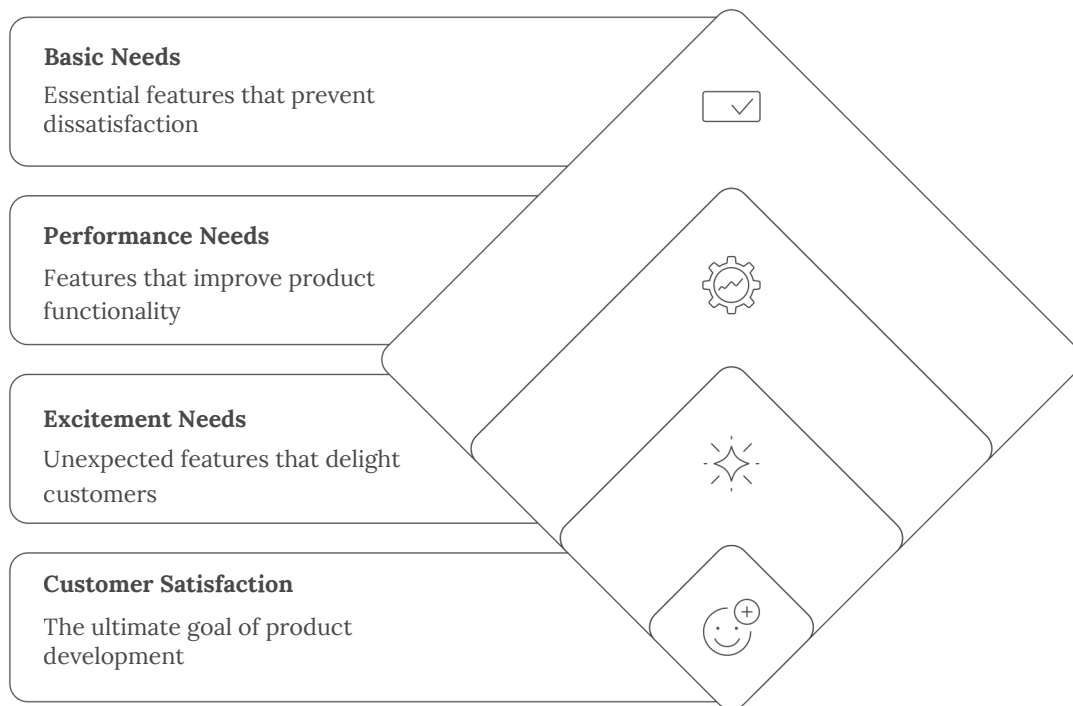
PERFORMANCE NEED : More = better, directly drives satisfaction

EXCITEMENT NEED : Unexpected delight – creates love for product

Features to classify : [LIST YOUR FEATURES ONE PER LINE]

After classifying : which Excitement feature should I build next to create maximum delight? Which Basic Need am I most at risk of failing on?

Kano Model of Customer Satisfaction



PRO TIP

The most dangerous Kano insight is the feature that was Excitement two years ago and is now Basic Need. Your competitors have copied it. Your customers expect it. If it's not flawless now, it's actively hurting you. Run this audit every six months.

Pairs well with: 2.1 Value Proposition · 2.5 JTBD · 3.8 Voice of Customer

MODULE 3

Know Your Market

See your competitive landscape clearly before you move.

WHAT THIS MODULE DOES

Most founders think they know their market because they operate in it every day. But operating in a market and understanding it strategically are two different things. This module gives you the tools to audit your position, read your competitive environment, define who you are actually for, and ground your decisions in real customer data not assumptions.

IN THIS MODULE

3.1 SWOT Analysis

3.2 PESTLE Analysis

3.3 Porter's Five Forces

3.4 Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

3.5 TAM SAM SOM

3.6 Competitor Mapping

3.7 Market Positioning Statement

3.8 Voice of Customer — Empathy Grid

3.9 STP Model — Segment, Target, Position

3.10 Perceptual Mapping

Start here if you are new to AI, or your prompts feel hit-or-miss.

3.1 — SWOT Analysis

A structured snapshot of where you stand right now

USE THIS WHEN

You need a clear, honest picture of your current position before making a major decision: a new market entry, a fundraiser, a product pivot, or a new partnership.

THE FRAMEWORK

Created at Stanford Research Institute in the 1960s and attributed to Albert Humphrey, SWOT maps four dimensions: **Strengths** (internal advantages you control), **Weaknesses** (internal limitations you control), **Opportunities** (external conditions you can exploit), **Threats** (external conditions that could hurt you). The real value is not in completing the grid — it's in the strategic questions the grid generates. AI can fill a SWOT in minutes and then analyse the strategic implications.

Origin: Albert Humphrey, Stanford Research Institute — SWOT framework, 1960s

HOW TO USE IT

1. Complete the internal factors (S and W) first — you know these best.
2. For Opportunities and Threats, brief AI with industry context before prompting.
3. After completing the grid, ask AI for strategic implications — not just the list.
4. Run SWOT annually and after any major market shift.

COMMON MISTAKE

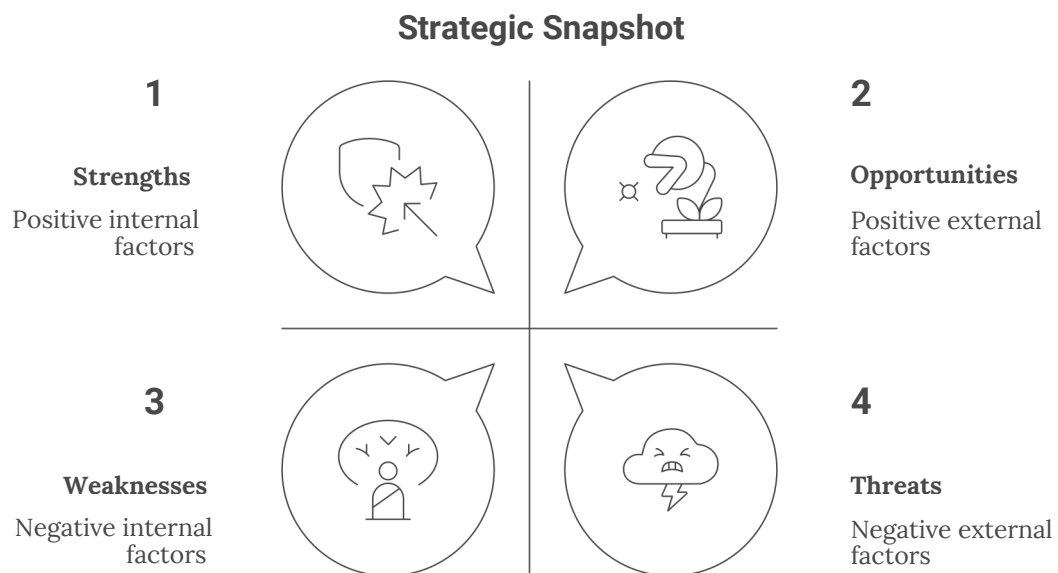
Most SWOT analyses list 20 items across four boxes and then sit in a drawer. The framework only creates value when you use it to make decisions: which strength counters which threat, which opportunity addresses which weakness. Without that cross-analysis step, SWOT is inventory, not strategy.

Act as a strategic analyst. Build a comprehensive SWOT for:

Business : [YOUR COMPANY NAME AND WHAT IT DOES]
Industry : [YOUR MARKET AND KEY COMPETITORS]
Stage : [REVENUE, TEAM, KEY MARKETS]
Context : [WHAT DECISION YOU ARE ABOUT TO MAKE]
STRENGTHS : Internal advantages – what we do better
WEAKNESSES : Internal limitations – where we are vulnerable
OPPORTUNITIES : External conditions we can exploit now
THREATS : External conditions that could hurt us

Give 4–5 points per quadrant. Be specific.

After the grid: give 3 strategic actions one to leverage a strength, one to fix a critical weakness, one to capture the best opportunity before it closes.



PRO TIP

The most useful output from SWOT is not the grid itself – it's the SO strategies (use Strengths to capture Opportunities) and the WT strategies (reduce Weaknesses to avoid Threats). Ask AI to generate those strategies explicitly. Most people stop at the grid and never get to the insight.

3.2 — PESTLE Analysis

Read the macro environment before it reads you

USE THIS WHEN

You're entering a new market, geography, or sector and you need to understand the external forces that could accelerate or kill your plan political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Francis Aguilar at Harvard in 1967, PESTLE is a macro-environment scan across six dimensions: **Political** (government policy and stability), **Economic** (growth, inflation, interest rates), **Social** (demographics, culture, behaviour trends), **Technological** (innovation, disruption, digital adoption), **Legal** (regulations, compliance), **Environmental** (sustainability, climate, physical). AI has broad knowledge across all six dimensions and can generate a detailed PESTLE in minutes when given the right context.

Origin: Francis Aguilar, Harvard Business School — Scanning the Business Environment, 1967

HOW TO USE IT

1. Define the market, geography, and industry before prompting context is everything.
2. Ask AI to flag which PESTLE factors are currently most active or fast-changing.
3. Turn the highest-impact factors into assumptions in your Lean Canvas.
4. Revisit PESTLE before any major market entry or strategic shift.

IN PRACTICE

Before Monzo launched in the UK, its team ran a PESTLE analysis and identified two critical factors: FCA regulatory changes opening challenger bank licensing, and a generational shift in how under-35s trusted traditional banks. Neither was in the existing competitor analysis. Those two factors not the product features became the foundation of Monzo's go-to-market timing and positioning.

Act as a macro-environment analyst using the PESTLE framework.

Business context : [YOUR INDUSTRY AND WHAT YOU DO]

Market / geography : [SPECIFIC MARKET YOU ARE ANALYSING]

Decision : [WHAT YOU ARE DECIDING BASED ON THIS ANALYSIS]

Analyse all six PESTLE dimensions:

POLITICAL : Government, policy, trade, stability

ECONOMIC : Growth, inflation, consumer spending, rates

SOCIAL : Demographics, culture, behaviour trends

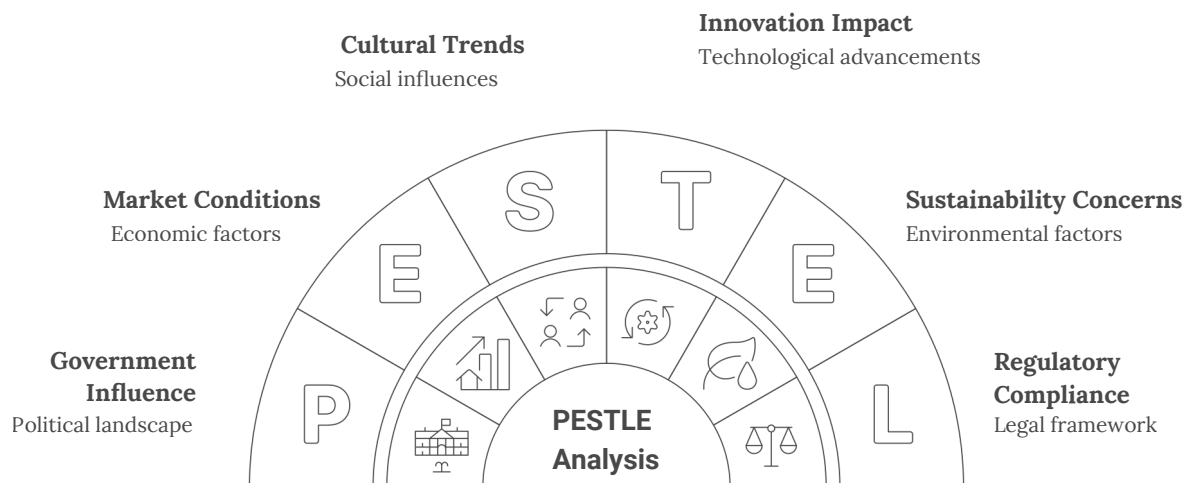
TECHNOLOGICAL : Innovation, AI, digital adoption, disruption

LEGAL: Regulations, compliance, IP, data law

ENVIRONMENTAL : Sustainability, ESG, climate impact

For each: give 2–3 specific factors and their likely impact on my business.

Flag the top 2 highest-risk factors I should act on now.



PRO TIP

Run PESTLE before entering any new geography especially India, Southeast Asia, or the Middle East where political and legal environments change faster than most founders expect. The factors that kill international expansion are almost always in the P and L dimensions, not the market size.

Pairs well with: 3.1 SWOT · 3.3 Porter's Five Forces · 8.5 Scenario Planning

3.3 — Porter's Five Forces

Understand the true profitability and power dynamics of your industry

USE THIS WHEN

You want to understand why some businesses in your industry are profitable and others aren't or you're deciding whether to enter or exit a market and need a rigorous structural analysis.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Michael Porter at Harvard Business School in 1979, the Five Forces model maps the structural forces that determine industry profitability: **Competitive Rivalry** (intensity of competition), **Threat of New Entrants** (how easy is it to enter?), **Threat of Substitutes** (what else could customers use?), **Bargaining Power of Buyers** (how much power do customers have?), **Bargaining Power of Suppliers** (how much power do your suppliers have?). The collective strength of these forces determines the long-run profit potential of an industry.

Porter's insight was that profitability is not random it is structural. A brilliant strategy in a structurally weak industry will always underperform a mediocre strategy in a structurally strong one.

Origin: Michael Porter, Harvard Business School — Competitive Strategy, 1979

HOW TO USE IT

1. Assess each force on a scale of Low, Medium, or High intensity.
2. Identify which force is most dangerous to your specific position.
3. Look for forces you can influence through strategic action, not all forces are fixed.
4. Use the output to decide where to build your moat.



Five Forces maps the industry you are in today, not the one you are building toward. Analysing the wrong industry boundary is the most common mistake when applying this framework.

Act as a strategic industry analyst using Porter's Five Forces.

Industry : [YOUR SPECIFIC INDUSTRY be precise]

My position : [WHAT YOU DO, YOUR SIZE, YOUR SEGMENT]

Analyse all five forces:

COMPETITIVE RIVALRY : How intense is competition?

THREAT OF NEW ENTRANTS : How easy to enter this market?

THREAT OF SUBSTITUTES : What else could customers use?

BUYER POWER : How much leverage do buyers have?

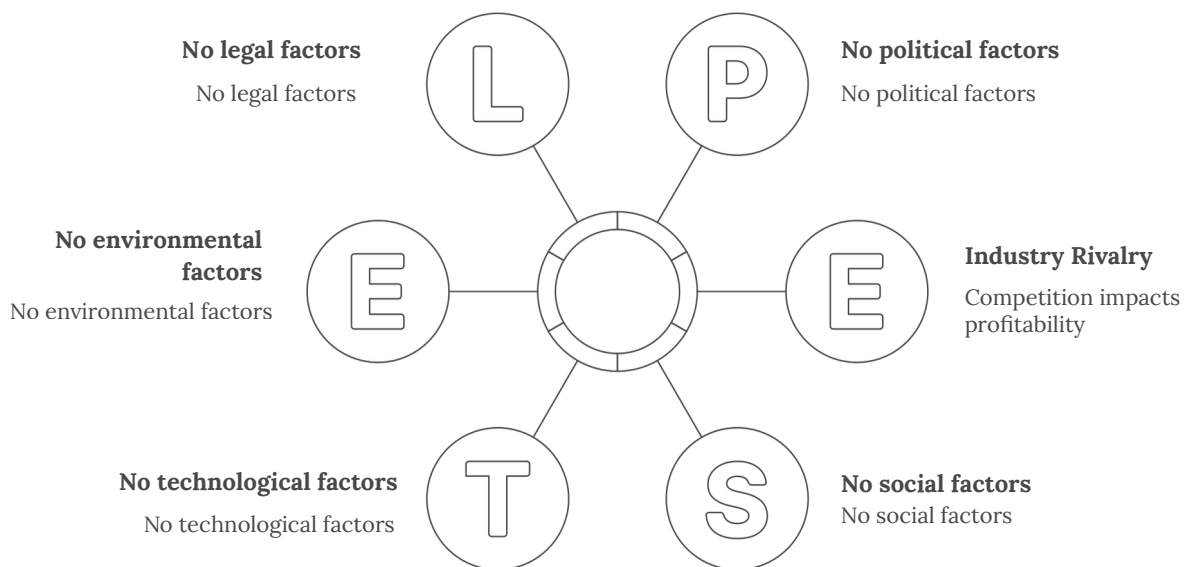
SUPPLIER POWER : How much leverage do suppliers have?

Rate each force : Low / Medium / High.

Identify the most dangerous force for my specific position.

Suggest 2 strategic moves to reduce the impact of the highest-threat force on my business.

Porter's Five Forces Analysis



PRO TIP

The most overlooked force is Threat of Substitutes. Customers don't just compare you to competitors, they compare you to doing nothing, doing it manually, or using a completely different category. Ask AI specifically: 'What are the non-obvious substitutes for my product that I might be underestimating?'

Pairs well with: 3.1 SWOT · 2.4 Blue Ocean · 2.8 Moat Builder · 3.6 Competitor Mapping

3.4 — Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Stop selling to everyone. Start selling to the right one.

USE THIS WHEN

Your conversion rates are low, your sales cycles are long, and your customers vary wildly in how much they value your product. You're spending equal time on accounts that become long-term partners and accounts that churn in 90 days.

THE FRAMEWORK

The Ideal Customer Profile defines the specific type of company or individual **who will get the most value from your product, buy fastest, pay most, and stay longest**. It is not a target audience, it is a precise description of your best-fit customer based on firmographic, behavioural, and situational criteria. Building sales and marketing around your **ICP dramatically improves conversion, reduces churn, and focuses your team on the accounts most likely to grow**.

Origin: B2B sales and marketing best practice — ICP methodology widely adopted 2010s

HOW TO USE IT

1. Start by analysing your existing best customers, look for patterns in industry, size, role, and problem.
2. Define your ICP in at least five dimensions: industry, company size, role, trigger event, and outcome sought.
3. Build a negative ICP too, the profile that looks like a fit but consistently disappoints.
4. Review and update your ICP every six months as you learn more from real customers.

COMMON MISTAKE

The most common ICP mistake is building from assumptions rather than interviewing your 10 best customers. They will tell you exactly why they bought and what they'd lose without you. Your assumptions will be wrong.

Act as a B2B sales strategist helping me define my ICP.

My product : [DESCRIBE WHAT IT DOES AND THE PROBLEM IT SOLVES]

Best customers so far : [DESCRIBE 2–3 THAT GOT THE MOST VALUE]

Build my Ideal Customer Profile across these dimensions:

FIRMOGRAPHIC : Industry, company size, geography, revenue

ROLE : Job title, seniority, decision-making authority

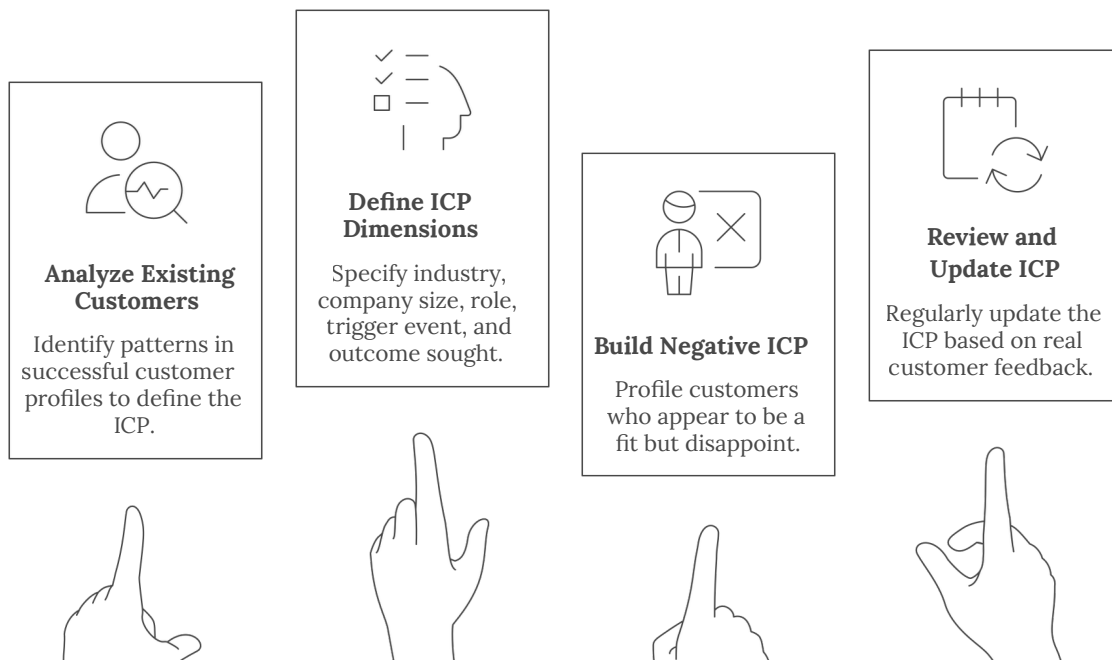
TRIGGER : What event makes them start looking for a solution?

PAIN : The specific problem they urgently need solved

OUTCOME : The result they need to see to call this a success

DISQUALIFIER : What makes a prospect a bad fit despite looking right?

Write the ICP as a one-paragraph description I can share with my sales and marketing team. Also give me the 3 fastest signals to identify this customer in a first conversation.



PRO TIP

Define your negative ICP with the same rigour as your positive one. The accounts that look like perfect fits but churn in 90 days have a pattern. Ask AI to help you find it. Disqualifying bad-fit accounts early is more valuable than closing them, a churned customer costs you more than a lost deal.

Pairs well with: 3.9 STP Model · 2.1 Value Proposition · 4.3 BANT Qualification

3.5 — TAM SAM SOM

Show investors and yourself - exactly how big this can get

USE THIS WHEN

An investor asks how big your market is and you either say a very large number from a generic report or you have no credible answer. You need a market sizing methodology that is defensible and specific to your actual business.

THE FRAMEWORK

TAM SAM SOM is the standard market sizing framework used by investors and strategists. **Total Addressable Market** (TAM) is the total global revenue opportunity if you captured 100% of the market. **Serviceable Addressable Market** (SAM) is the portion you can realistically reach with your current model. **Serviceable Obtainable Market** (SOM) is the realistic share you can capture in the next 3–5 years. The most common mistake is starting with TAM and working down. The best founders build bottom-up from real unit economics and work up.

Origin: Venture capital due diligence methodology — TAM SAM SOM widely used 1990s onwards

HOW TO USE IT

1. Build your SOM first from bottom-up: number of target accounts × average contract value.
2. Work up to SAM by expanding the customer definition while keeping your delivery model.
3. Use TAM to show the theoretical ceiling, but never lead with it.
4. Always show both top-down and bottom-up calculations, the difference reveals your assumptions.



A TAM number from a generic market report will kill your credibility with an experienced investor faster than having no number at all. Build bottom-up from real unit economics, always.

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a venture capital analyst helping me build a credible market sizing model.

My business : [DESCRIBE WHAT YOU SELL AND TO WHOM]

Geography : [YOUR TARGET MARKETS]

Price point : [YOUR AVERAGE DEAL / CONTRACT VALUE]

Build both top-down and bottom-up sizing for:

TAM : Total global revenue opportunity, all potential customers using any solution for this problem

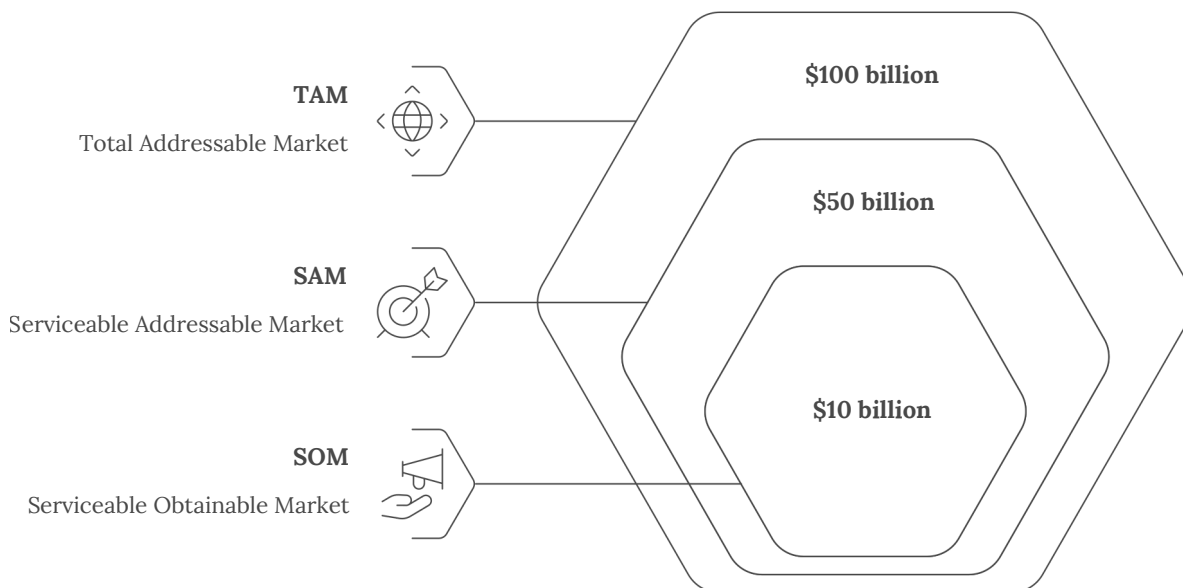
SAM : Realistic reachable market with my current model and go-to-market approach

SOM : Achievable share in 3–5 years based on realistic growth assumptions

Bottom-up : Number of ICP accounts × ACV = realistic SOM

Flag the key assumptions and the biggest risks to the sizing model.

TAM SAM SOM – Market Sizing Made Honest



PRO TIP

Investors are sceptical of top-down market sizing because anyone can find a large number. The founders who impress are those who say 'bottom-up, we see 12,000 companies that fit our ICP, average deal size is X, that gives us a Y SOM with Z% penetration in year 3.' That level of specificity signals you actually know your market.

Pairs well with: 3.4 ICP · 9.5 Investor Narrative · 2.9 Ansoff Matrix

3.6 — Competitor Mapping

See exactly where you stand and where the gaps are

USE THIS WHEN

You're losing deals to competitors and don't fully understand why. Or you're preparing a market-entry strategy and need to know the landscape before you move.

THE FRAMEWORK

Competitor mapping is the structured process of plotting your competitors across dimensions that matter to your customers **price, capability, speed, service model, target segment, and key differentiators**. Done well, it reveals clusters of competition (where everyone is fighting), white spaces (where no one plays), and your own positioning clarity. AI can build a preliminary map quickly when given enough context about your market.

Origin: Strategic management methodology — competitor analysis frameworks, 1980s onwards

HOW TO USE IT

- 
1. List your top 5–8 direct and indirect competitors before prompting.
 2. Choose 4–6 dimensions that your customers actually use to evaluate options.
 3. Look for white spaces combinations of dimensions that no competitor occupies.
 4. Update your map every six months or after any significant competitor move.

COMMON MISTAKE



Most competitor maps list only direct competitors by product category. The most dangerous competitors are often indirect, the workaround your customer uses instead of buying anything. Spreadsheets, manual processes, and doing nothing are your biggest competitors in most B2B markets. Map the workaround first, then the direct alternatives.

Act as a competitive intelligence analyst.

My business : [WHAT YOU DO AND WHO YOU SERVE]

Key competitors : [LIST 5–8 DIRECT AND INDIRECT]

Map each competitor across these dimensions:

- Price positioning (budget / mid / premium)
- Target customer (SMB / mid-market / enterprise)
- Core strength (what they are known for)
- Core weakness (where they are consistently criticised)
- Key differentiator (what makes them choose-able)

After mapping :

1. Where is the market most crowded?
2. What white space exists that no competitor occupies?
3. Where am I most vulnerable to competitive pressure?
4. What is the one thing I must own to be clearly different?



PRO TIP

The most valuable output is not the map itself, it is the white space analysis. Ask AI specifically: 'Given this competitive map, describe the customer who is currently underserved by every player in this market.' That customer is your Blue Ocean opportunity.

Pairs well with: 3.3 Porter's Five Forces · 2.4 Blue Ocean · 3.7 Positioning Statement

3.7 — Market Positioning Statement

The one sentence that tells your customer exactly why you not anyone else

USE THIS WHEN

Your team describes your product differently to every prospect. Your website headline changes every six months. Competitors are eroding your differentiation and you can't articulate a sharp, ownable reason to choose you.

THE FRAMEWORK

Al Ries and Jack Trout established in their 1981 work Positioning: **The Battle for Your Mind that positioning is not what you do to a product, it is what you do to the mind of a prospect.** Most businesses position by accident: they describe what they do and hope the right customer self-selects. Deliberate positioning works the opposite way you choose the customer, the category, and the comparison point, then build every word of your message to reinforce that choice. The goal is a statement so specific it automatically excludes the wrong customer and makes the right one feel it was written for them.

Origin: Al Ries & Jack Trout, Positioning: The Battle for Your Mind, 1981

HOW TO USE IT

1. Draft three positioning statements before deciding AI can generate all three.
2. Test each one: does it exclude anyone? If it appeals to everyone, it works for no one.
3. Share with 5 real customers and ask which one makes them lean forward.
4. Once locked, use it as the master filter for all marketing and sales copy.

IN PRACTICE

Oatly's positioning statement wasn't built around 'plant-based milk alternative.' It was built around a specific enemy: the dairy industry lobby. Their statement polarised the market intentionally, people who agreed with their position became advocates, not just customers. Positioning works best when it defines who you are NOT for as clearly as who you are for.

Act as a brand positioning strategist.

My business : [DESCRIBE WHAT YOU DO]

Target customer : [SPECIFIC ROLE, INDUSTRY, SITUATION]

Key competitors : [WHO THEY COMPARE US TO]

Our main differentiator : [WHAT WE DO THAT OTHERS DON'T]

Proof point : [DATA, RESULT, OR CREDENTIAL THAT BACKS IT UP]

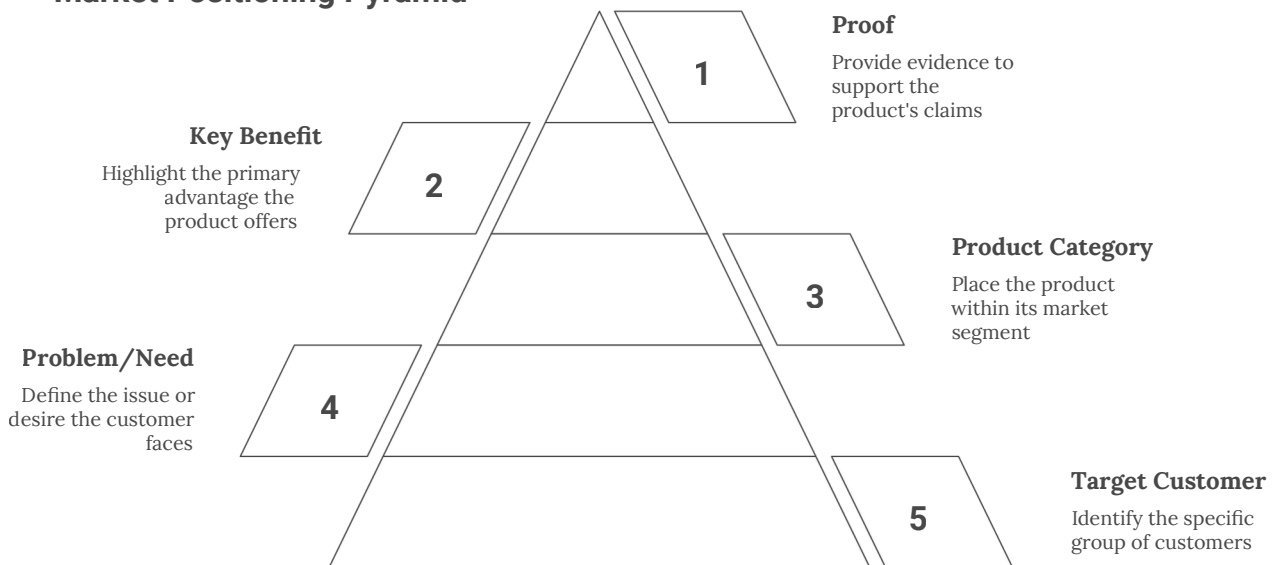
Write 3 positioning statements in this format:

For [TARGET CUSTOMER] who [PROBLEM OR NEED], [PRODUCT] is the [CATEGORY] that [KEY BENEFIT] because [REASON TO BELIEVE].

Make each one distinct not just different words for the same idea.

Vary the angle of differentiation. Then recommend which of the three is sharpest and why.

Market Positioning Pyramid



PRO TIP

After writing your positioning statement, do a simple test: remove your company name and replace it with a competitor's. If the statement still works for them, you don't have a positioning, you have a category description. Push harder on the 'because' clause. That's where real differentiation lives.

Pairs well with: 3.6 Competitor Mapping · 5.1 StoryBrand · 3.4 ICP · 3.10 Perceptual Map

3.8 — Voice of Customer Empathy Grid

Get inside your customer's head before building or writing anything

USE THIS WHEN

You're writing marketing copy, designing a feature, or preparing a sales pitch but you're writing from your perspective, not your customer's. Your message is accurate but it doesn't land.

THE FRAMEWORK

The Empathy Grid, popularised by IDEO and widely used in design thinking, maps **what your customer Thinks and Feels, Sees, Hears, Says and Does, and their Pains and Gains**. Combined with **Voice of Customer** (VOC) research - the actual words customers use to describe their problems - it builds a rich picture of the customer's inner world. AI can simulate this map quickly when given enough context, and help you extract VOC language from customer interviews or reviews. A grid built from assumptions just formalizes your own guesses. VOC matters because customers rarely describe problems the way you'd describe your solution.

Origin: IDEO Design Thinking — Empathy Map, popularised early 2000s

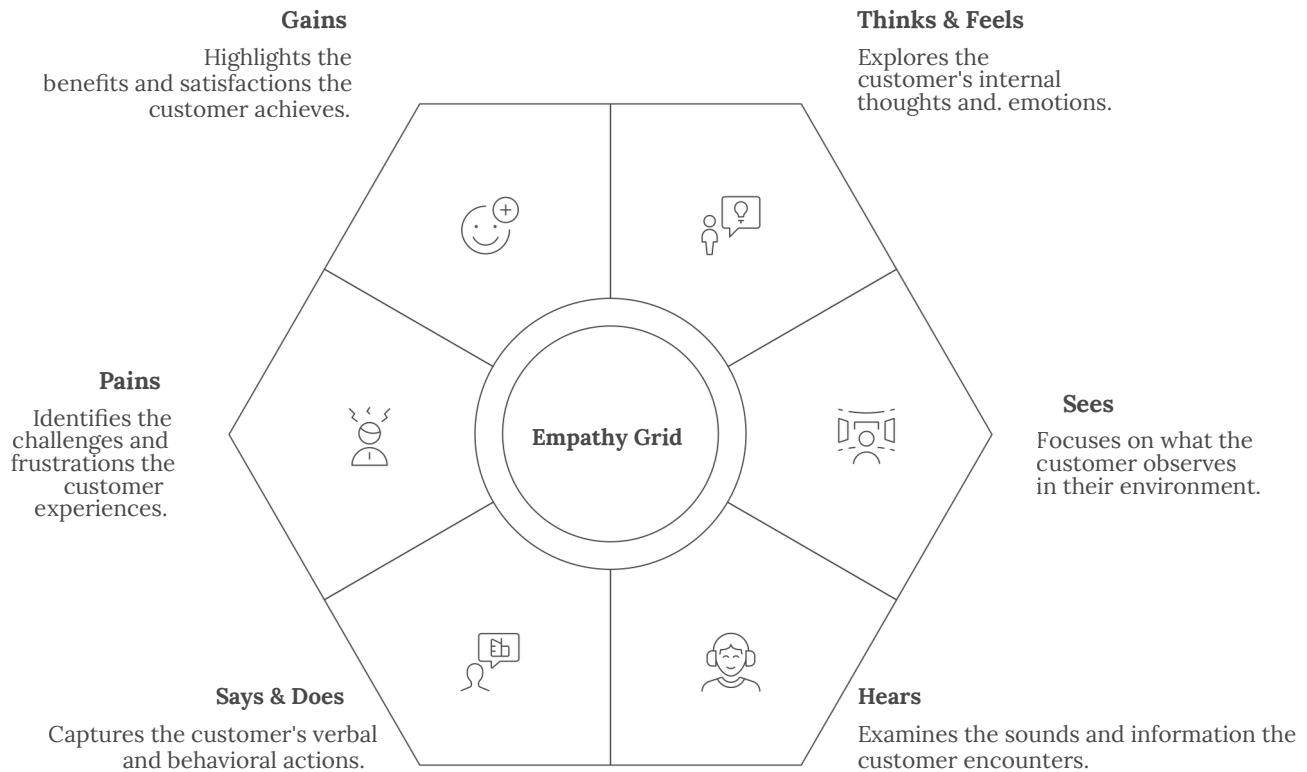
HOW TO USE IT

1. Feed AI your customer's industry, role, and the problem they face. 2. Also paste in any real customer reviews, interview notes, or support tickets you have.
2. Focus especially on the Pains and Gains quadrants, these drive copy and product decisions.
3. Pull exact phrases from the VOC output and use them verbatim in your marketing.



AI can simulate an empathy map but it cannot replace real customer conversations. Use the AI output as a hypothesis - then verify at least three points directly with an actual customer before writing copy or making product decisions

Empathy Grid Framework



AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a customer research analyst using the Empathy Grid.

Customer profile : [ROLE, INDUSTRY, COMPANY SIZE]

Problem context : [WHAT CHALLENGE THEY FACE DAILY]

Real customer data (if available):

[PASTE REVIEWS, INTERVIEW NOTES, OR SUPPORT TICKETS]

Map the full Empathy Grid:

THINKS & FEELS : Inner concerns, hopes, and worries

SEES : What their environment looks like

HEARS : What colleagues, managers, media tell them

SAYS & DOES : Public behaviour and statements

PAINS : Frustrations, fears, obstacles

GAINS : Desired outcomes and measures of success

After the grid: give me 5 exact phrases this customer would use to describe their problem in their own words, not marketing language.

Pairs well with: 2.1 Value Proposition · 2.5 JTBD · 3.4 ICP · 5.1 StoryBrand

3.9 — STP Model - Segment, Target, Position

Choose your market deliberately, don't let the market choose you

USE THIS WHEN

You're spreading your marketing budget across too many audiences and seeing weak results everywhere. Or you're about to launch a new product and need to decide which customer segment to go after first.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Philip Kotler, the STP Model is a **three-stage strategic marketing process**. **Segmentation** divides the total market into distinct groups with different needs or behaviours. Targeting evaluates each segment and chooses which to focus on, based on **size, growth, accessibility, and fit with your capabilities**. Positioning then defines how you want to be perceived by the chosen segment relative to competitors. STP prevents the costly mistake of trying to be everything to everyone.

Origin: Philip Kotler, Marketing Management — STP framework, 1967 onwards

HOW TO USE IT

1. Map your market into at least 4–6 distinct segments before evaluating which to target.
2. Score each segment on attractiveness and your ability to win in it, not just size.
3. For the chosen target segment, write a positioning statement using Framework 3.7.
4. Resist targeting more than two segments until you have fully won the first.



The most expensive STP mistake is targeting the largest segment instead of the most winnable one. A smaller segment where you have a clear advantage will outperform a large segment where you are one of many.

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a marketing strategist using the STP framework.

My business : [DESCRIBE YOUR PRODUCT AND CURRENT MARKET]

Total market : [THE BROAD MARKET YOU OPERATE IN]

SEGMENTATION :

Divide the total market into 5–6 distinct customer segments based on industry, need, behaviour, or size. Describe each segment in 2–3 lines.

TARGETING:

Score each segment 1–5 on:

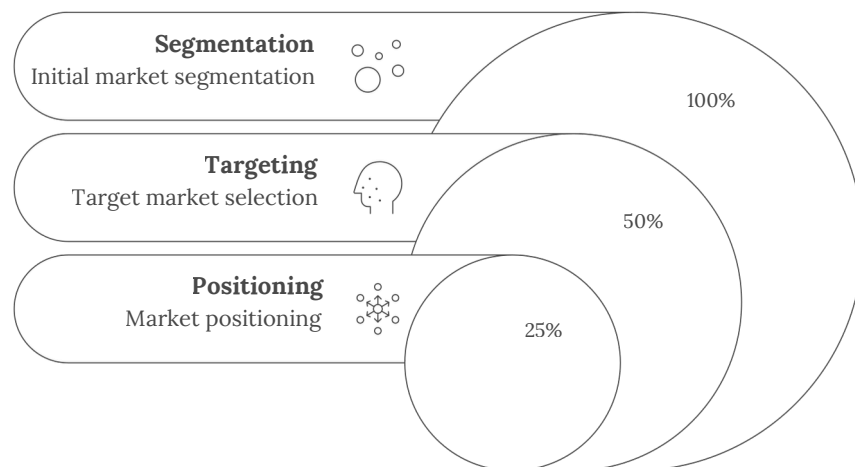
- Market size and growth rate
- Fit with my current capabilities
- Competitive intensity in this segment
- Likely profitability and retention

Recommend the top 1–2 segments to target first.

POSITIONING:

For the top segment, write one positioning statement that clearly differentiates me from alternatives.

STP Model – Choose Your Market. Own Your Position.



PRO TIP

Most founders target the largest segment, not the most winnable one. The most winnable segment is where you have a natural advantage, a network, a credential, an insight, that competitors don't. Winning one segment completely is worth more than partial penetration of three.

Pairs well with: 3.4 ICP · 3.7 Positioning Statement · 5.4 Marketing Mix · 5.6 GTM Canvas

3.10 — Perceptual Mapping

See your market the way your customers actually see it

USE THIS WHEN

You believe you occupy a distinct position in your market but customers keep comparing you to competitors you think are very different from you. Your perception of your position and the market's perception don't match.

THE FRAMEWORK

Perceptual mapping is a visual tool used in marketing strategy to plot how customers perceive brands or products relative to each other on key dimensions. The two axes represent the attributes that most influence customer choice in your market, **typically price vs quality, or specialist vs generalist, or traditional vs innovative**. Where you land on the map reflects customer perception, not your own. AI can generate a perceptual map description and help you identify where the white spaces and repositioning opportunities are.

Origin: Marketing strategy methodology — perceptual mapping widely used 1960s onwards

HOW TO USE IT

1. Choose your two most important customer-decision dimensions as axes.
2. Plot your brand and key competitors based on how customers perceive them, not how you see them.
3. Look for white spaces, positions on the map that no competitor occupies.
4. If your position overlaps heavily with competitors, repositioning may be necessary.

IN PRACTICE

Most perceptual maps use price and quality as the two axes because they're easy to measure. The maps that reveal real opportunity use the axes customers actually use to choose, speed vs reliability, personal vs professional, complex vs simple. Ask your best customers: 'When you're choosing between us and an alternative, what two things matter most?' Their answer is your map.

Act as a brand strategist using perceptual mapping.

My brand : [YOUR COMPANY AND WHAT IT DOES]

Competitors : [LIST 5–6 KEY COMPETITORS]

Customer decision factors : [WHAT CUSTOMERS WEIGH MOST WHEN CHOOSING IN THIS CATEGORY]

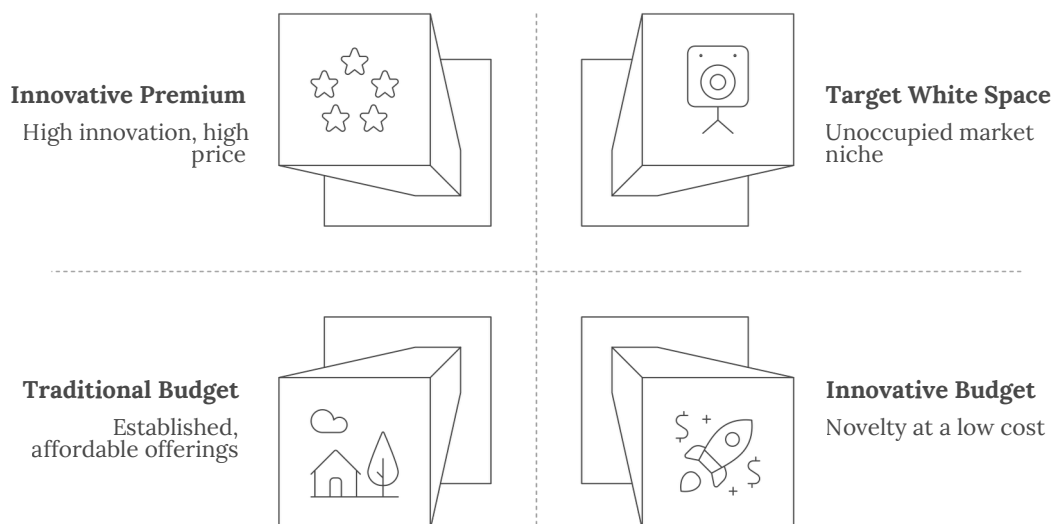
Step 1 : Recommend the 2 best axes for this market's perceptual map, the dimensions that most drive customer perception and choice.

Step 2 : For each competitor and my brand, describe where they would land on the map and why.

Step 3 : Identify any white space, an unoccupied position that a sizeable customer segment values.

Step 4 : Recommend whether I should hold my current position or reposition and where to move.

Map Brands Effectively



PRO TIP

Run the same perceptual map twice: once based on how you believe customers see the market, and once asking AI to reflect what customer reviews and public sentiment actually say. The gap between your internal map and the external one is your most important strategic insight.

MODULE 4

Sell Like a Pro

Build a machine that turns cold strangers into paying customers.

WHAT THIS MODULE DOES

Sales is the one skill that pays for every other mistake in business. You can have an average product with great sales and survive. You cannot have a great product with no sales and survive. This module gives you the complete sales toolkit from cold outreach to closing, from objection handling to pipeline management all powered by AI prompts that prepare you for every stage of the conversation.

IN THIS MODULE

- 4.1 Cold Outreach — AIDA
- 4.2 SPIN Selling — Discovery Call Framework
- 4.3 Lead Qualification — BANT & CHAMP
- 4.4 The Challenger Sale
- 4.5 Objection Handling — LAER
- 4.6 PAS — Problem Agitate Solve
- 4.7 Proposal Writing — Win Story
- 4.8 Follow-Up Sequences
- 4.9 Pipeline Review — Deal Health Check
- 4.10 Closing Techniques Matrix
- 4.11 FAB — Features Advantages Benefits

Start here if you are new to AI, or your prompts feel hit-or-miss.

4.1 — Cold Outreach — AIDA

Write messages that get opened, read, and replied to

USE THIS WHEN

Your cold emails and LinkedIn messages get ignored. You're writing about your product when the prospect hasn't yet agreed that they have a problem. Your outreach sounds like everyone else's.

THE FRAMEWORK

AIDA is one of the oldest marketing frameworks in existence, created by Elias St. Elmo Lewis in 1898. It maps the journey from cold contact to action: **Attention** (stop the scroll - make them read the first line), **Interest** (build relevance - make them feel this is about them), **Desire** (create urgency - make them want the outcome), **Action** (clear single next step). Most cold outreach fails at Attention. The first line of any message must be so relevant or intriguing that not reading the rest feels like a loss.

Origin: Elias St. Elmo Lewis — AIDA model, 1898

HOW TO USE IT

1. Write three variations of your opening line before sending, the best one is rarely the first.
2. Never start a cold message with your name, company, or what you do.
3. The Action step should be frictionless, a question, not a calendar link.
4. Personalise the Attention line for each prospect, generic attention doesn't work.



The most expensive STP mistake is targeting the largest segment instead of the most winnable one. A smaller segment where you have a clear advantage will outperform a large segment where you are one of many.

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a B2B cold outreach copywriter using the AIDA framework.

My product : [WHAT YOU SELL AND THE PROBLEM IT SOLVES]

Target prospect : [ROLE, INDUSTRY, COMPANY SIZE]

Specific trigger : [WHY REACH OUT NOW news, funding, job change, content they posted]

Desired action : [ONE THING YOU WANT THEM TO DO]

Write 3 cold outreach messages using AIDA:

ATTENTION : First line stops them specific to them

INTEREST : Connects their world to the problem you solve

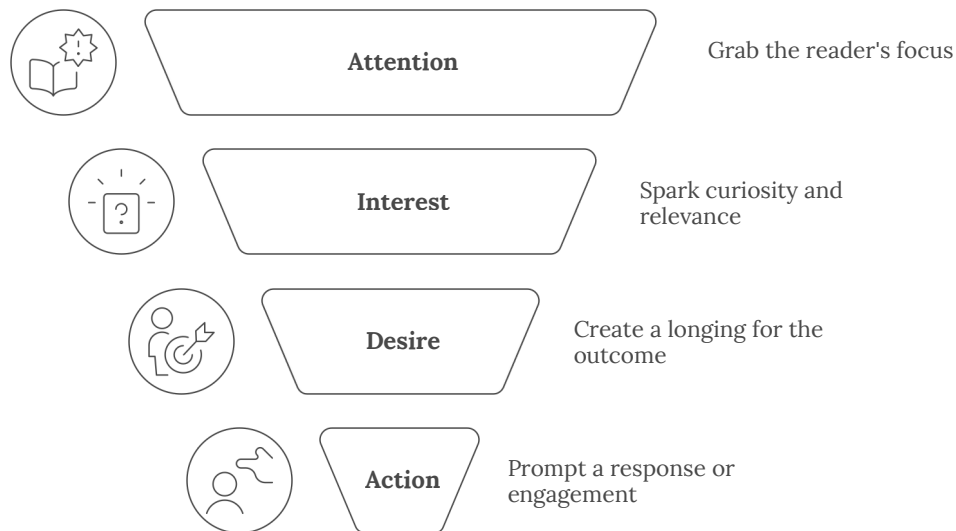
DESIRE : Outcome they want not features you have

ACTION : One low-friction next step

Keep each message under 100 words.

Make each variation use a different opening angle.

AIDA – The Cold Outreach Journey



PRO TIP

The single biggest improvement to cold outreach response rates is the first sentence. Write it about them, not about you. Reference something real and specific a post they wrote, a company announcement, a problem specific to their industry right now. AI can research this context - use it.

Pairs well with: 4.6 PAS · 4.8 Follow-Up Sequences · 3.4 ICP · 5.2 Hook Framework

4.2 — SPIN Selling - Discovery Call Framework

Turn every sales call into a structured insight session

USE THIS WHEN

You're talking too much and pitching too early on discovery calls. You leave without fully understanding what the prospect actually needs and they leave without feeling heard.

THE FRAMEWORK

Neil Rackham analysed 35,000 sales calls over 12 years and found that **high-value sales** are won through questions, not pitches. SPIN replaces pitching with structured questioning: **Situation questions establish context, Problem questions surface pain, Implication questions show the cost of inaction, Need-Payoff questions let the prospect articulate** why they need your solution in their own words. The prospect who convinces themselves is the easiest to close.

Skipping Implication is what makes a close feel pushed rather than earned. A prospect who says out loud why the problem matters will defend that far harder than any pitch could.

Origin: Neil Rackham, SPIN Selling, 1988

HOW TO USE IT

1. Prepare 3 questions for each SPIN stage before every call use the prompt below.
2. Ask all Situation questions first, then move to Problem. Never pitch before Need-Payoff
3. After the call, paste the transcript into AI and ask it to identify which SPIN stage each exchange covered.
4. The goal of a discovery call is for the prospect to articulate the problem and the value of solving it not for you to explain your product.

Act as a B2B sales coach using Neil Rackham's SPIN Selling.

I am selling : [YOUR PRODUCT OR SERVICE]

Prospect role : [JOB TITLE AND INDUSTRY]

Known context : [WHAT YOU KNOW ABOUT THEM ALREADY]

Generate 3 strong questions for each SPIN stage:

SITUATION : Understand their current state and setup

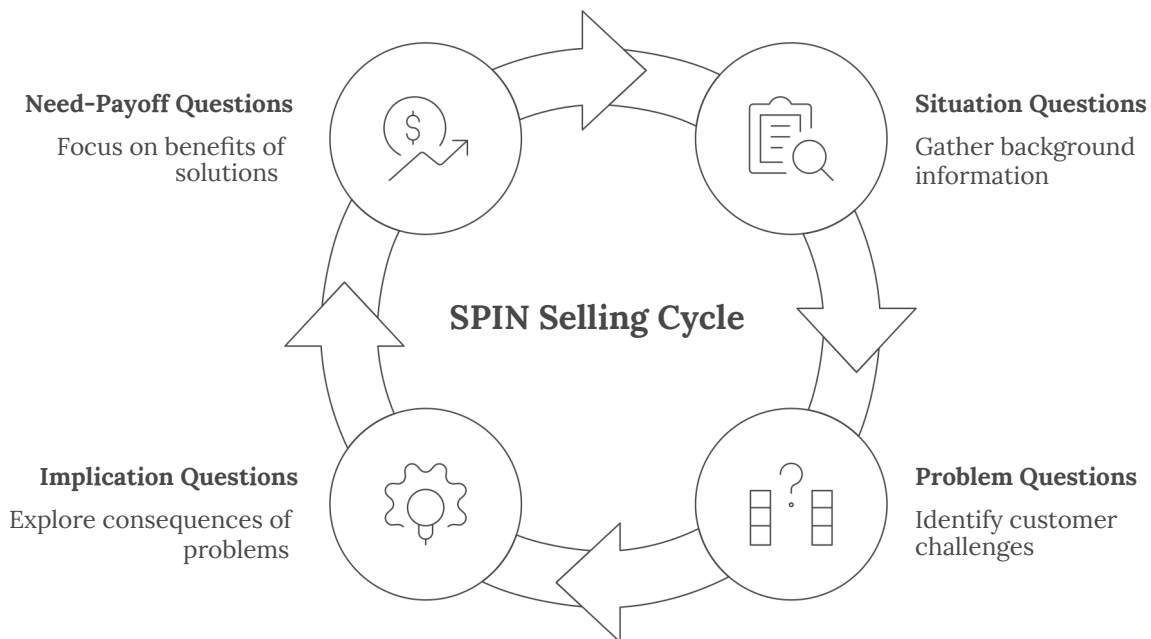
PROBLEM : Surface the pain they may not have named

IMPLICATION : Show the cost and consequence of not solving it

NEED-PAYOFF : Let them articulate the value of solving it

#Make questions feel like natural conversation. #Avoid yes/no questions.

Favour open questions. #Sequence them so each stage flows into the next.



PRO TIP

Spend 70% of your call on Implication questions that is where urgency is created. Most salespeople rush to Need-Payoff without building enough implication first. A prospect who hasn't felt the pain of inaction will not feel urgency to act.

Pairs well with: 4.3 BANT Qualification · 4.5 Objection Handling · 4.7 Proposal Writing

4.3 — Lead Qualification BANT & CHAMP

Stop spending time on prospects who will never buy

USE THIS WHEN

You're investing hours in prospects who go dark, say they need to think about it, or reveal at the end of a long process that they don't have budget or that someone else makes the decision.

THE FRAMEWORK

BANT (**Budget, Authority, Need, Timeline**) was developed by IBM as a qualification framework. A prospect must have all four to be a real opportunity. CHAMP (**Challenges, Authority, Money, Prioritisation**) is a modern evolution that starts with the customer's challenge rather than your budget question making it less transactional and more consultative. AI can help you build qualification questions that feel like discovery, not interrogation.

Origin: IBM — BANT framework, 1950s–60s · HubSpot — CHAMP evolution

HOW TO USE IT

1. Qualify early ideally in the first call, not after a proposal.
2. Never ask about budget directly. Ask about what they have invested in similar solutions previously.
3. Authority is trickier than it looks there are often multiple decision-makers. Map the buying committee.
4. If any BANT element is missing, decide whether to nurture, disqualify, or escalate.



The most expensive STP mistake is targeting the largest segment instead of the most winnable one. A smaller segment where you have a clear advantage will outperform a large segment where you are one of many.

Act as a B2B sales qualification coach.

My product: [WHAT YOU SELL AND AVERAGE DEAL SIZE]

Prospect: [ROLE, INDUSTRY, WHAT YOU KNOW ABOUT THEM]

Generate qualification questions for both frameworks:

BANT QUALIFICATION:

- **Budget:** How do I uncover budget without asking directly?
- **Authority:** How do I map the decision-making process?
- **Need:** How do I confirm this is a real priority?
- **Timeline:** How do I understand their urgency without pressure?

CHAMP QUALIFICATION:

- **Challenges:** What is the core problem driving this search?
- **Authority:** Who else is involved in this decision?
- **Money:** What have they invested in alternatives?
- **Prioritisation:** Where does this rank against other initiatives?

Write 2 natural-sounding questions per category.



Budget-Focused Qualification



Authority Assessment



Need Assessment



Timeline Assessment



Challenge-Focused Qualification



Authority Assessment



Money Assessment



Prioritisation Assessment

CHAMP prioritises customer challenges for effective qualification.

BANT

CHAMP

PRO TIP

The most important qualification question is Timeline - but never ask it first. Ask it after you've built the pain clearly. A prospect with no timeline usually has no urgency, which means no deal. Timeline answers tell you whether to invest or to place in a nurture sequence.

Pairs well with: 4.2 SPIN Selling · 4.4 Challenger Sale · 4.9 Pipeline Review

4.4 — The Challenger Sale

Teach prospects something they don't know then lead them to your solution

USE THIS WHEN

You're selling to prospects who say they're satisfied with how things are. You're in competitive situations where all vendors look similar. Relationship-building alone isn't winning deals anymore.

THE FRAMEWORK

Based on a five-year study of 6,000 sales professionals by Matthew Dixon and Brent Adamson, The Challenger Sale found that the highest-performing reps don't just **build relationships, they challenge the customer's thinking**. The Challenger approach has three moves: **Teach** (share a provocative insight the prospect hasn't considered), **Tailor** (connect the insight to the specific business or individual), **Take Control** (guide the conversation toward your unique solution confidently). The insight you teach must be counterintuitive and directly connected to a problem only you solve.

Origin: Matthew Dixon & Brent Adamson, *The Challenger Sale*, 2011

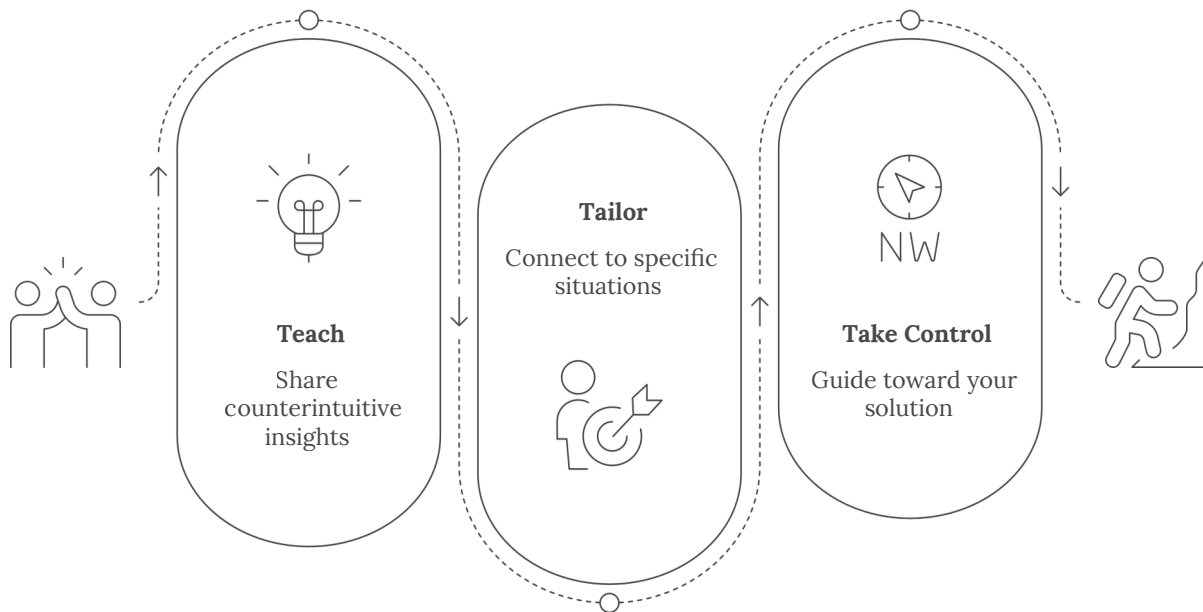
HOW TO USE IT

1. Build your Challenger insight before any sales conversation, use the prompt below.
2. The insight must be specific to the prospect's industry and genuinely surprising.
3. Teach the insight first before connecting it to your product sequence matters.
4. Practice delivering the insight in under 90 seconds without sounding like a pitch.

PRO TIP

The insight you teach must be something the prospect genuinely didn't know — not something they agree with immediately. If they nod too fast, you haven't challenged them. The best Challenger insights make the prospect slightly uncomfortable. That discomfort is the opening.

The Challenger Sale



AI PROMPT — COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a Challenger Sale strategist.

My product: [WHAT YOU SELL AND THE PROBLEM IT SOLVES]

Prospect type: [INDUSTRY, ROLE, COMPANY STAGE]

Common assumption: [WHAT THEY CURRENTLY BELIEVE OR DO THAT YOUR PRODUCT CHALLENGES]

Build a full Challenger approach:

TEACH: What counterintuitive insight about their industry or business would genuinely surprise them?

(must be specific, data-backed, and relevant)

TAILOR: How does this insight connect specifically to their role, their pain, or their goals?

TAKE CONTROL: How do I guide from the insight to the conversation about my solution — naturally,

without feeling like a pivot?

Write the opening 3–4 sentences I would say out loud.

Also write the Take Control transition — the bridge from the insight to my solution in 1–2 sentences.

Pairs well with: 4.2 SPIN Selling · 4.5 Objection Handling · 4.7 Proposal Writing

4.5 — Objection Handling - LAER

Turn resistance into a deeper conversation, not a debate

USE THIS WHEN

A prospect raises an objection and you immediately counter it with a feature or a price justification. They feel unheard, push back harder, and the conversation dies. You're winning arguments and losing deals.

THE FRAMEWORK

Developed by Carew International, the LAER model is a four-step objection response framework built on one principle: an objection is a request for more information, not an attack to defend against. **Listen** (fully, without interrupting), **Acknowledge** (validate their concern before responding), **Explore** (ask a question to understand the objection more deeply), and **Respond** (only now address it with precision). Skipping Explore is the most common mistake. Most objections have a deeper concern underneath the surface one.

Origin: Carew International — LAER objection handling methodology

HOW TO USE IT

1. Never respond to an objection in the same breath you heard it, pause.
2. Acknowledge before you explore - validation opens people, defence closes them.
3. Use the Explore question to find what is really underneath the objection.
4. Prepare LAER responses for your top 5 most common objections using the prompt below.

PRO TIP

'We need to think about it' is never about thinking. It is always about one of three things: they don't see enough value, they don't have authority, or they don't have urgency. The Explore question reveals which one it is. Without that question, you're responding to the wrong problem.

Act as a sales coach using the LAER objection handling framework.

My product : [WHAT YOU SELL AND AVERAGE PRICE POINT]

For each objection below, write a full LAER response:

Objection 1 : [YOUR MOST COMMON OBJECTION]

Objection 2 : [YOUR SECOND MOST COMMON OBJECTION]

Objection 3 : 'We don't have budget right now.'

Objection 4 : 'We need to think about it.'

Objection 5 : 'We're already using [COMPETITOR].'

For each objection use this structure:

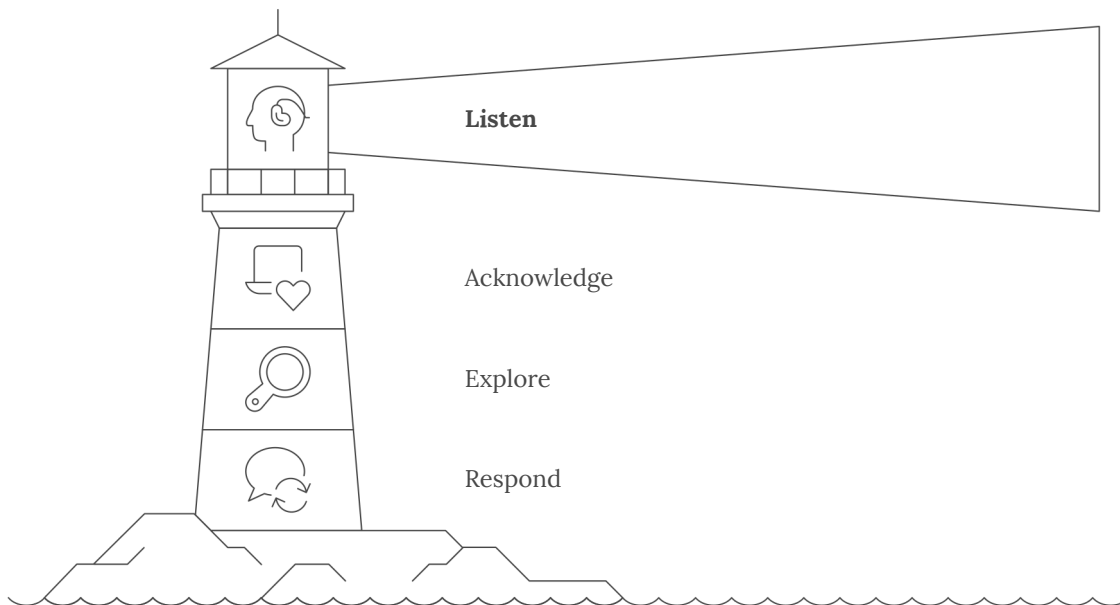
LISTEN : (note what to observe / not interrupt)

ACKNOWLEDGE : Exact words to validate their concern

EXPLORE : One open question to uncover the real issue

RESPOND : Precise response to the likely real concern

LAER – Turn Objections Into Conversations



The most expensive STP mistake is targeting the largest segment instead of the most winnable one. A smaller segment where you have a clear advantage will outperform a large segment where you are one of many.

Pairs well with: 4.2 SPIN Selling · 4.4 Challenger Sale · 4.10 Closing Techniques

4.6 — PAS - Problem Agitate Solve

Write copy that creates urgency without manipulation

USE THIS WHEN

Your marketing copy explains what you do but creates no emotional urgency. Prospects read it, understand it, and still do nothing. The information is there, the feeling isn't.

THE FRAMEWORK

PAS is a direct response copywriting framework popularised by Dan Kennedy and widely used across sales pages, cold emails, LinkedIn posts, and pitch decks. **Problem:** name the specific pain the prospect feels. **Agitate:** expand the consequences - what happens if this problem goes unsolved? What does it cost them in time, money, reputation, or opportunity? **Solve:** present your solution as the logical answer to the agitated problem. The Agitate step is where most founders stop short, they name the problem but never make the reader feel its weight.

Origin: Dan Kennedy — PAS framework, Direct Response copywriting methodology

HOW TO USE IT

1. Name the problem in the exact language your customer uses, not your language.
2. In the Agitate step, go one level deeper than the obvious consequence.
3. The Solve step should feel like relief, not a pitch.
4. Test PAS as your email subject line, LinkedIn opening line, and website headline.

PRO TIP

The Agitate step works best when it names a second-order consequence, not just the direct pain but what that pain causes next. 'You're losing deals' is a problem. 'You're losing deals, and your best salespeople are starting to question whether the product is the issue' is agitation. That second sentence hits differently.

Act as a direct response copywriter using the PAS framework.

My product : [WHAT YOU SELL]

Target customer : [WHO THEY ARE AND THEIR CONTEXT]

Core problem : [THE MAIN PAIN YOU SOLVE]

Channel : [EMAIL / LINKEDIN POST / WEBSITE HEADLINE]

Write 3 PAS variations for this channel:

PROBLEM : Name the specific pain, their words, not yours

AGITATE : Expand the consequences, what does this cost them in time, money, stress, missed opportunity?

SOLVE : Present the solution as natural relief

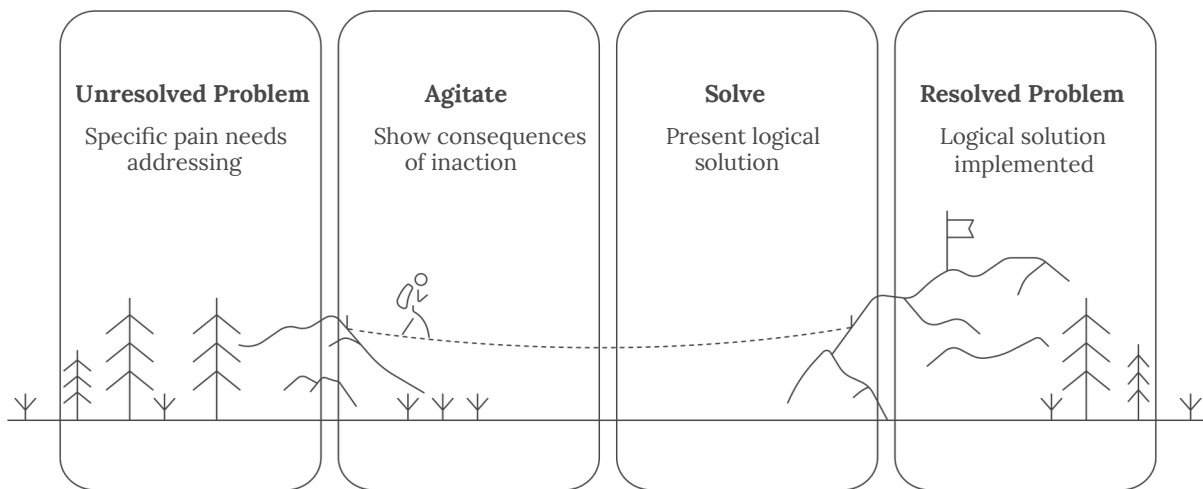
Variation 1 : Lead with the financial cost of the problem

Variation 2 : Lead with the emotional cost

Variation 3 : Lead with what they are missing out on

Keep each under 80 words. No jargon.

PAS Framework for Problem Solving



The most expensive STP mistake is targeting the largest segment instead of the most winnable one. A smaller segment where you have a clear advantage will outperform a large segment where you are one of many.

Pairs well with: 4.1 Cold Outreach · 5.1 StoryBrand · 4.7 Proposal Writing · 5.2 Hook Framework

4.7 — Proposal Writing — Win Story

Write proposals that close, not just inform

USE THIS WHEN

You send detailed, professional proposals that prospects read, compliment, and then go silent on. Your proposals are comprehensive but they don't compel action. They document your solution but don't tell a story.

THE FRAMEWORK

A Win Story is a proposal structure that mirrors how humans make decisions - through narrative, not specifications. The structure has six parts: **Situation** (their world as it is today), **Complication** (the problem and its cost), **Resolution** (what success looks like), **Solution** (your approach- positioned as the bridge from complication to resolution), **Proof** (evidence that you can deliver), and **Call to Action** (one clear, specific next step). The key difference from a standard proposal is that the customer's story comes first. Your solution is a supporting character, not the lead.

Origin: Solution selling methodology — Win Story narrative structure

HOW TO USE IT

1. Write the Situation and Complication sections using the prospect's exact words from your discovery call.
2. The Resolution section should describe their future state not your features.
3. Proof should be a specific result, not a general claim.
4. The Call to Action must be one thing not a list of next steps.

Proof Needs a Match

Generic proof is worse than none. If your Proof example doesn't mirror the Complication you named earlier, the reader notices the gap and starts doubting the rest of the proposal instead of trusting it.

Act as a proposal writing consultant using the Win Story structure.

Discovery call notes : [PASTE KEY POINTS FROM YOUR CALL]

My solution : [WHAT YOU ARE PROPOSING TO DO]

Proof available : [CASE STUDY, DATA, OR REFERENCE]

Desired next step : [WHAT YOU WANT THEM TO DO NEXT]

Write a complete Win Story proposal:

SITUATION : Their world as it is today their terms

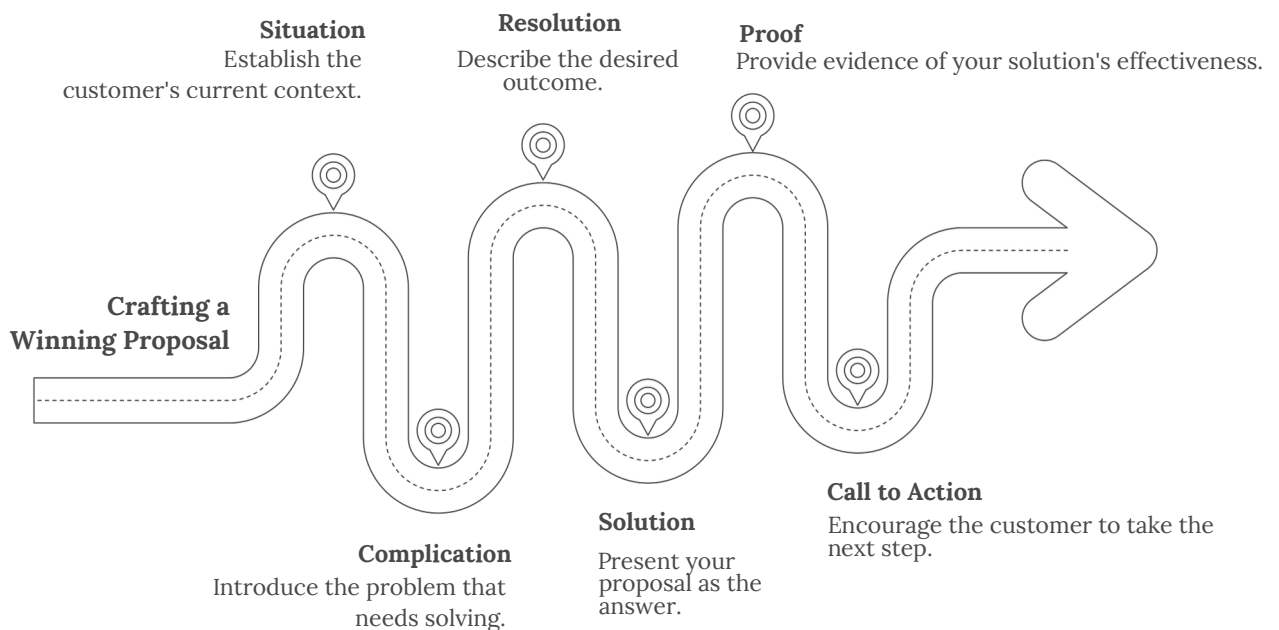
COMPLICATION : The problem and the cost of it continuing

RESOLUTION : What their world looks like when solved

SOLUTION : Your approach bridge to the resolution

PROOF : One specific result that proves delivery

CALL TO ACTION : One sentence, one next step, one date



PRO TIP

The single most impactful change to any proposal: move the executive summary to after the Complication section, not at the top. Prospects who feel their problem has been understood read proposals differently. Understanding before solution is the sequence that closes.

4.8 — Follow-Up Sequences

The sale rarely happens on the first contact, build the system that closes later

USE THIS WHEN

You send one follow-up after a meeting or proposal and then give up if you hear nothing. You assume silence means no. But most deals are decided after the fifth or sixth touchpoint and you're stopping at two.

THE FRAMEWORK

Research in B2B sales consistently shows that **80% of sales require five or more follow-ups, yet 44% of salespeople give up after one**. A follow-up sequence is a multi-touch, multi-channel cadence of value-adding contacts that keeps you visible without being pushy. Each touch should add something new, a relevant insight, a case study, an answer to an unanswered question rather than asking 'just checking in.' AI can build an entire sequence for a specific deal in minutes.

Origin: B2B sales research — follow-up cadence methodology, widely documented 2010s

HOW TO USE IT

1. Never follow up with 'just checking in' every touch must add value.
2. Vary the channel: email, LinkedIn, phone, voice note, video message.
3. Space touches 3–5 business days apart in the first two weeks, then weekly.
4. Build a break-up email for touch 6 or 7 it often gets the highest response rate.

Don't let AI turn your follow-ups into spam.

A sequence built in minutes still needs your judgment before it sends. If touch three reads like touch one with new words swapped in, the prospect notices before you do. Persistence without a real reason to reach out reads as pressure, not value and pressure gets you blocked, not booked

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a B2B sales sequence strategist.

Deal context : [WHAT YOU PROPOSED AND WHAT THEY SAID]

Prospect role : [JOB TITLE AND INDUSTRY]

Last contact : [WHAT HAPPENED IN YOUR LAST INTERACTION]

Build a 7-touch follow-up sequence:

Touch 1 (Day 1) : Post-meeting summary and one insight

Touch 2 (Day 3) : Relevant content or case study

Touch 3 (Day 6) : Answer a question they didn't ask yet

Touch 4 (Day 10) : Social proof specific to their industry

Touch 5 (Day 15) : New angle challenge their status quo

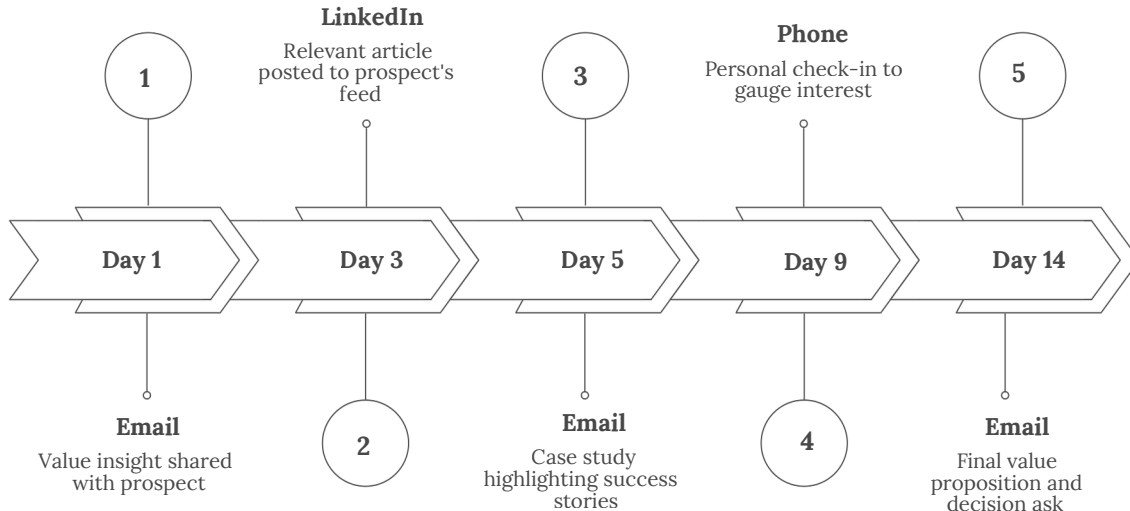
Touch 6 (Day 22) : Offer to simplify or reduce scope

Touch 7 (Day 30) : Break-up email honest and respectful

For each touch : write the subject line and opening sentence.

Keep every message under 60 words.

Follow-Up Cadence : 80% of Sales Need 5+ Touches



PRO TIP

The break-up email (Touch 7) consistently generates the highest reply rate of any touch in a sequence. Something about 'I'm going to stop reaching out' creates a response that seven other emails didn't. Write it genuinely not as a manipulation tactic. If you really are moving on, say so honestly.

Pairs well with: 4.1 Cold Outreach · 4.9 Pipeline Review · 4.5 Objection Handling

4.9 — Pipeline Review - Deal Health Check

Know which deals will close before your forecast does

USE THIS WHEN

Your pipeline looks healthy but your close rate is lower than expected. Deals sit in the same stage for weeks. You discover deals are stuck or dead - too late to recover them.

THE FRAMEWORK

A Deal Health Check is a structured review of each active opportunity against a set of objective criteria: Is there a **confirmed problem**? Have you spoken to the **real decision-maker**? Is there a defined **budget**? Is there a **timeline** with consequences for missing it? Have **objections** been surfaced and addressed? Is there a mutual **next step** with a date? Deals that can't answer all six questions are at risk regardless of what the CRM stage says. AI can conduct a deal health review when you describe the deal's current state.

Origin: Salesforce / CRM methodology — pipeline management best practice

HOW TO USE IT

1. Review every deal over 21 days old against the six criteria every week.
2. Any deal without a confirmed next step with a date is not active it is stalled.
3. Move stalled deals to a nurture sequence rather than leaving them in the active pipeline.
4. Use the output to identify your one highest-risk deal and take action this week.

Don't let a scorecard replace your judgment.

Six yes-answers don't guarantee a close, and one "no" doesn't mean walk away. Deals are made by people, not checklists - a stalled deal with a strong relationship can still move. Use the health check to focus your attention, not to make the decision for you.

AI PROMPT – COPY & PASTE READY

Act as a sales pipeline analyst conducting a deal health review.

For each deal I describe, score it against six criteria

(Yes / Partial / No) and give a health rating:

CRITERIA:

- 1. Confirmed problem** : Do they acknowledge the pain clearly?
- 2. Decision-maker** : Have I spoken directly to the buyer?
- 3. Budget** : Is budget confirmed or realistically available?
- 4. Timeline** : Is there a defined date with stakes attached?
- 5. Objections** : Have key objections been surfaced and handled?
- 6. Next step** : Is there a mutual commitment with a date?

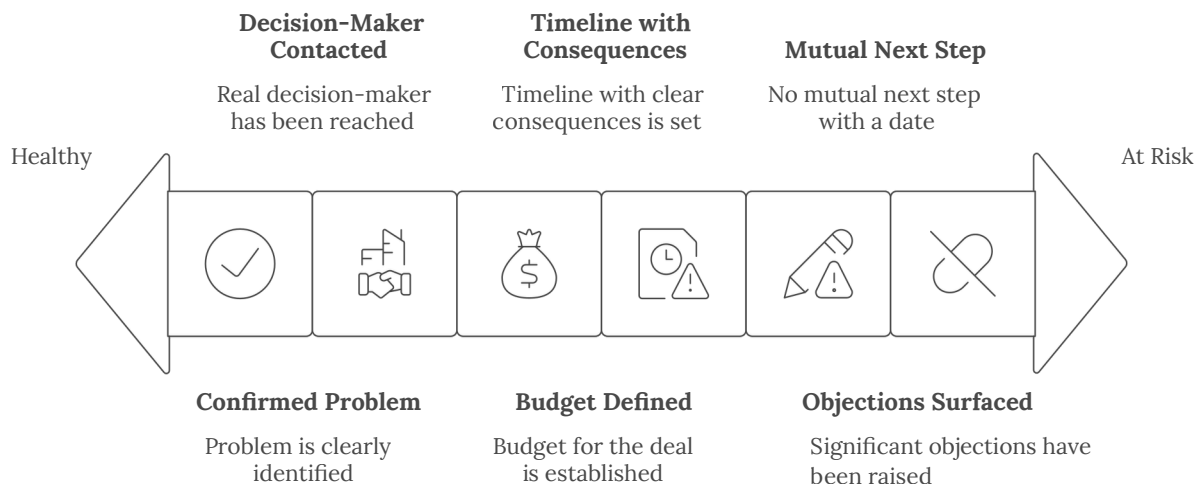
Deal 1 : [STAGE, LAST CONTACT, WHAT WAS AGREED, WHAT IS BLOCKING]

Deal 2 : [STAGE, LAST CONTACT, WHAT WAS AGREED, WHAT IS BLOCKING]

For each : Health rating (Strong / At Risk / Stalled)

and one specific action to take this week.

Deal health check ranges from healthy to at risk.



PRO TIP

The most honest pipeline review question is: 'If this deal were to close, what would have to happen in the next 7 days?' If you can't answer that specifically, the deal has no momentum. Deals without momentum don't close, they disappear.

Pairs well with: 4.3 BANT Qualification · 4.8 Follow-Up · 4.10 Closing Techniques

4.10 — Closing Techniques Matrix

Choose the right close for the right moment, not the only one you know

USE THIS WHEN

You reach the end of a great sales conversation and don't know how to move it forward. Or you default to the same closing approach every time and it stops working for certain prospect types.

THE FRAMEWORK

Closing is not a single technique it is a set of contextual tools. Different situations require different approaches. **The Summary Close** (recap all agreed value, then ask for the decision) works when the prospect is convinced but hesitant. **The Alternative Close** (offer two options, both of which move forward) works when they're stuck on one variable. **The Assumptive Close** (proceed as if the decision is made, surface any remaining concerns) works when signals are positive. **The Question Close** (ask what would make them comfortable to proceed) works when the real objection hasn't been named. AI can help you identify which close fits your current deal situation.

Origin: Classic sales training methodology — closing techniques documented widely

HOW TO USE IT

1. Never try to close before the prospect has confirmed the value and urgency.
2. Match the close to the prospect's personality analytical buyers hate assumptive closes.
3. If the close fails, use it as a diagnostic ask what would need to be true to move forward.
4. Prepare your close in advance for every meeting don't improvise it.

Timing Beats Technique

No closing method rescues a conversation where value was never confirmed. If you're reaching for the Alternative Close to escape awkward silence, you're using it as a rescue tool, not a decision tool. Fix the conversation, not the close.

Act as a sales closing coach.

My deal : [DESCRIBE THE DEAL STAGE, WHAT'S BEEN AGREED, WHAT HESITATION REMAINS]

Prospect personality : [ANALYTICAL / RELATIONSHIP / DECISIVE]

Recommend the best closing approach for this situation from these options:

SUMMARY CLOSE : Recap value, ask for decision

ALTERNATIVE CLOSE : Two paths forward, both say yes

ASSUMPTIVE CLOSE : Move forward as if decided

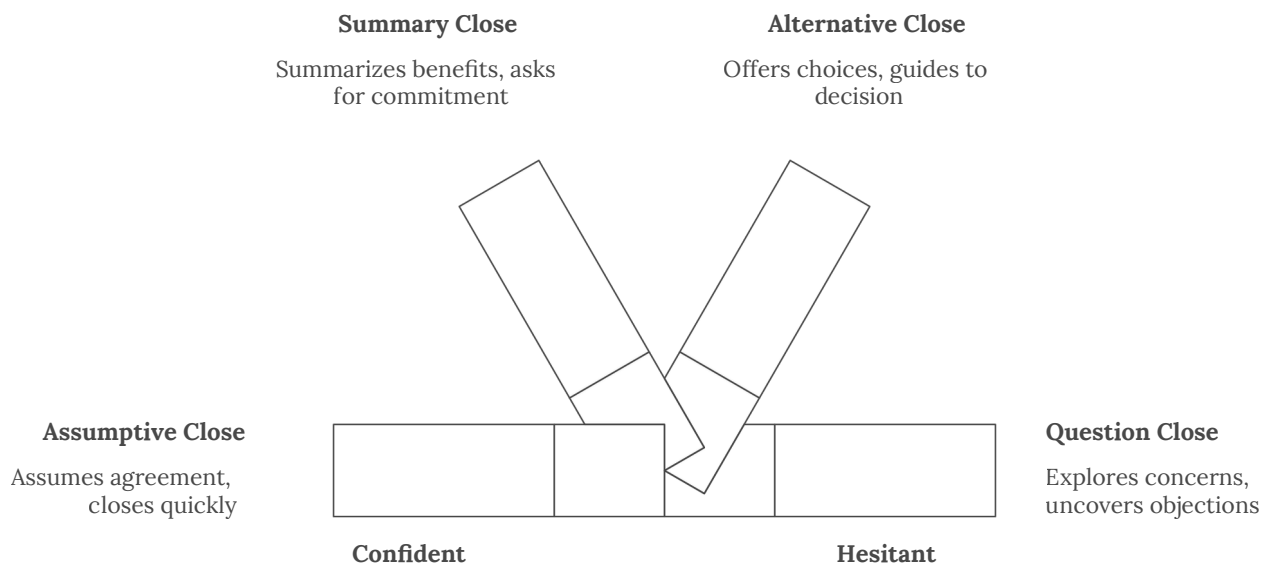
QUESTION CLOSE : Ask what would make them comfortable

URGENCY CLOSE : Name a real consequence of delay

Write the exact words I would say out loud for the recommended close.

Then write a recovery if they say not yet.

Closing techniques range from direct to exploratory.



PRO TIP

The best close is the one you use before you think you need to close. When all signals are positive value confirmed, objections handled, timeline agreed ask for the decision. Most salespeople wait for perfect certainty before closing. That certainty rarely arrives. Move when the signals are there.

Pairs well with: 4.5 Objection Handling · 4.9 Pipeline Review · 4.2 SPIN Selling

4.11 — FAB - Features Advantages Benefits

Stop listing what your product does. Start saying what it means for them.

USE THIS WHEN

You describe your product by listing features and specifications. Prospects nod politely and then say they'll think about it. The features are real and impressive but they're not translating into desire.

THE FRAMEWORK

FAB is a foundational sales communication framework dating to the 1960s. **Features** describe what a product has or does. **Advantages** explain why that feature is better than the alternative. **Benefits** describe what the feature and advantage mean for this specific customer in their specific situation. Most salespeople stop at Feature or Advantage. **The customer only cares about the Benefit** and even then, only the benefit that is relevant to their specific pain. AI can translate any feature into a customer-specific benefit when given the right context.

Origin: Sales training methodology — FAB framework, widely attributed to 1960s salesmanship

HOW TO USE IT

1. List your top 5–7 features before prompting.
2. For each feature, ask: 'So what does that mean for a customer who has this specific problem?'
3. Match benefits to the customer's stated pain from your discovery call not generic benefits.
4. Use the benefit language verbatim in proposals, demos, and email follow-ups.

Same Benefit, Different Buyer

The same feature means something different to each buyer - "less overtime" to an ops manager, "faster board reporting" to a CFO. One benefit statement for every prospect is still FA, not FAB.

Act as a sales messaging consultant using the FAB framework.

My product features : [LIST YOUR TOP 5-7 FEATURES]

Target customer pain : [THE SPECIFIC PROBLEM THEY TOLD YOU ABOUT IN DISCOVERY]

Customer role : [JOB TITLE AND WHAT THEY ARE MEASURED ON]

For each feature, complete the FAB chain:

FEATURE : What the product has or does

ADVANTAGE : Why this is better than the alternative

BENEFIT : What this specifically means for THIS customer given their stated pain and goals

Write the Benefit as a sentence they would say to their manager not a sentence I would say to them.

FAB Pyramid

Benefit

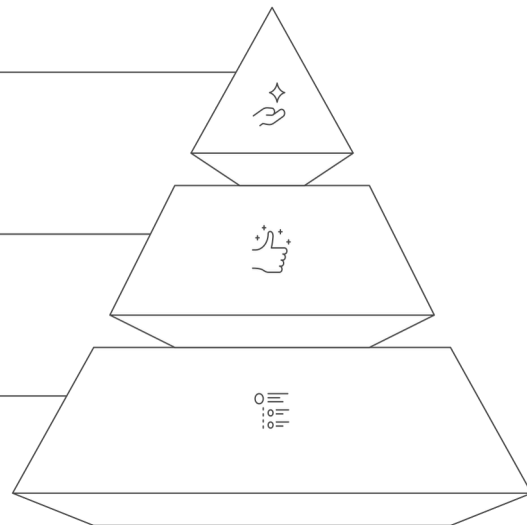
What it means for the customer

Advantage

Why it's better than alternatives

Feature

What the product has or does



PRO TIP

The best benefits are written from the customer's perspective looking inward, not from your perspective looking outward. 'This saves you 3 hours a week' is a feature-benefit. 'You can tell your CFO that reporting time dropped by 40%' is a customer benefit because it solves the customer's real problem, which is not time, it's accountability.